



CITY: Pg 3

CM launches waste collection project



NATION: Pg 5

Paper leak protests rock several states



FILM: Pg 12

Salman, Alia stand with protesters

ANTI-PAPER LEAK BILL NEXT WEEK, SAYS MODI; CJP DELEGATION TO MEET GOVT TODAY

WANGCHUK ENDS 26-DAY FAST, PM VOWS TOUGHER ACTION



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Activist Sonam Wangchuk ended his 26-day hunger strike on Thursday as Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced that the Union Cabinet would take up a bill proposing tougher action against examination paper leaks at its Friday meeting, while the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) agreed to hold its first formal talks with government ministers on Friday amid the continuing agitation over the alleged NEET-UG 2026 paper leak.

Wangchuk ended his fast at Medanta Hospital in Gurugram in the presence of Union ministers J P Nadda and Jitendra Singh. Visuals showed the two ministers helping him sip from a cup, while his wife, Gitanjali Angmo, stood beside him. "I'm grateful and happy to break my fast. Thank you," Wangchuk said while holding the hands of Nadda and Singh. Turning to his wife, he added, "Gitanjali has always been by my side and my support. I don't want to thank you but express my feelings."

Wangchuk had been on a hunger strike since June 28 in support of demands for reforms in the examination system and accountability over paper leaks. He had joined protesters at Delhi's Jantar Mantar alongside the student-led CJP, which has been spearheading demonstrations over alleged irregularities in the NEET-UG 2026 examination.

The Centre's engagement with the protesters also gathered pace, with a CJP delegation scheduled to meet government ministers at 12.30 pm on Friday. According to sources, the meeting will be the first formal interaction between the two sides after days of deadlock. The talks follow repeated attempts

KEY POINTS

- » Nadda and Jitendra Singh help Wangchuk break his fast
- » Wangchuk thanks supporters and praises wife Gitanjali Angmo
- » Wangchuk began fast on June 28 over paper leak reforms
- » CJP delegation to meet government ministers at 12.30 pm Friday
- » Friday meeting marks first formal Centre-CJP engagement
- » Modi announces anti-paper leak bill for Parliament next week
- » Union Cabinet to discuss proposed bill on Friday
- » Bill proposes tougher punishment and faster trials in paper leak cases

by the government to open a dialogue. On Thursday, Union minister J P Nadda invited the CJP leadership for discussions, but the outfit declined the offer, maintaining that any meeting should be held at a neutral venue close to the protest site.

Late on Thursday night, Modi said the government would place before the Union Cabinet a proposal containing stronger legal measures to tackle examination paper leaks. In a video statement, he said the Cabinet would discuss the framework on Friday before finalising the legislation.

"On Monday, when the second week of the Monsoon session of Parliament will begin, a bill will be brought with provisions for strong

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CJP intensifies nationwide push over NEET paper leak



AIMAN FATIMA ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: With its more than month-long agitation showing no signs of slowing down, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) has intensified its campaign by calling for a nationwide day of peaceful protests on Friday.

The CJP urged supporters, student unions and civil society groups to organise demonstrations on Friday in every district in solidarity with those it alleges were vic-

tims of police brutality during recent protests in Delhi.

Under the slogan "Every District. One Day. One Demand," the CJP has appealed to citizens across the country to assemble at designated locations, read out the students' demands, express solidarity with those allegedly injured during the July 20 "Sansad Chalo" march and submit memorandums to district authorities. The party has circulated campaign material, a standard operating

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Naresh Pal Gangwar replaces Vineet Joshi as new Higher Edu Secy

NEW DELHI: As protests against the NEET paper "leak" flared up, the Centre on Thursday shifted Higher Education Secretary Vineet Joshi to the Ministry of Panchayati Raj and appointed new officials to top positions in both the school education and higher education departments. Joshi was also holding the charge of school education secretary after Sanjay Kumar retired from the post on June 30. He was also the acting chairperson of the University Grants Commission (UGC).

According to officials, Joshi will now be posted as the secretary in the Ministry of Panchayati Raj.

While Naresh Kumar Gangwar has been appointed as the higher education secretary, T K Anil Kumar has been brought in as the school education secretary.

Gangwar was posted as the secretary in the Ministry of Animal Husbandry, while Kumar was

Continued on P4

BJP veteran Murli Manohar Joshi backs NEET protesters, says police action on students painful

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Former BJP president and veteran leader Murli Manohar Joshi on Thursday backed students protesting in Delhi over the alleged NEET paper leak, saying their concerns about the examination system were genuine and should be addressed with empathy instead of



force. In a post on X, the former Union minister urged the authorities to find a lasting solution rather than treating the agitation only as a law and order issue.

Joshi said it was painful to see students from different parts of the country spending days on the streets of the national capital. "Their anxieties and concerns

Continued on P4

Rahul, INDIA bloc MPs pay homage to NEET victims at 'Gandhi Smriti'

Allege curbs on peaceful march

AAISHA SABIR

NEW DELHI: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and several Opposition leaders on Thursday reached Gandhi Smriti on Tees January Marg to pay homage to students who died by suicide over the NEET paper leak controversy and to express solidarity with those injured during the recent police action on protesters.

The visit, however, was marked by heavy police presence, barricades and claims by the Congress that Opposition leaders were stopped from moving freely.

As Opposition MPs gathered at Rahul Gandhi's residence on Sunehri Bagh Road before, heavy police presence was seen. Police initially put up barricades on Sunehri Bagh Road to stop Congress and Youth Congress workers from moving towards Tees January Marg. The barricades were later removed, allowing Gandhi and the MPs to proceed.

In a post on X, Congress leader P Chidambaram said



Congress MPs Priyanka Gandhi, Rahul Gandhi and other INDIA bloc MPs pay tribute at Gandhi Smriti in New Delhi on Thursday

Some of the MPs also switched on torches on their mobile phones at the Gandhi Smriti

the MPs had been waiting inside the buses for over 25 minutes, alleging that roads across central Delhi had been barricaded and hundreds of police personnel deployed.

However, near Union

Home Minister Amit Shah's residence, the leaders were stopped again, with police citing prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), which prohibits the assembly of five or more people in the area. They were later allowed to continue towards Gandhi Smriti.

On reaching Gandhi Smriti, Gandhi and the opposition MPs paid homage to the departed students with folded hands, and later sang the national anthem. Gandhi carried a small copy of the Constitution with him while opposition MPs Mahua Mahji and Mahua Moitra were seen holding the national flag.

Some of the MPs also switched on torches on their mobile phones at the Gandhi Smriti. In a post on X, Gandhi said that "no one can stop them from standing with the students of India." "In solidarity with the students, we wanted to take the opposition MPs to India Gate. But they refused.

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FACE-OFF BETWEEN NDA AND INDIA BLOC Parliament proceedings washed out for 4th day over NEET fiasco



MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Parliament proceedings were stalled for the fourth consecutive day on Thursday as loud protests by an unrelenting opposition over the NEET paper leak and demand for Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation reverberated in both Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha, leading to adjournment of the two Houses for the day without transacting any business.

Outside the House, opposition and ruling party MPs staged protests and counter-protests and raised slogans against each other, signalling that the turmoil may not easily peter out.

Amid the ruckus, Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi and Samajwadi Party supremo Akhilesh Yadav met Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla. TMC leaders Saugata Roy and Mahua Moitra were also present in the meeting.

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EYES ON GLORY



India's weightlifter Mirabai Chanu and boxer Lovlina Borgohain carry the Indian tricolour during the opening ceremony of the 23rd Commonwealth Games, at the OVO Hydro, in Glasgow, on Thursday PTI

No ethanol in premium petrol; no plans to restore E0/E10 petrol, says Govt

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Centre on Thursday said premium grades of petrol sold by state-run fuel retailers will continue to be supplied without ethanol blending and clarified that there is no proposal to bring back E0 or E10 petrol or increase ethanol blending in regular petrol beyond the current 20 per cent.

Responding to questions in the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for Petroleum and Natural Gas Suresh Gopi said premium fuels such as Indian Oil Corporation's XP100, Hindustan Petroleum's poWer100 and Bharat Petroleum's Speed100 remain free from ethanol because they are specialised fuels with performance-enhancing additives. These premium grades account for about 0.5 per cent of the country's total petrol sales and are available only at select fuel stations. They are priced at around Rs 160 per litre, compared to Rs 102.12 per litre for regular E20 petrol.

Gopi said any future decision to increase ethanol blending beyond 20 per cent would be taken only after detailed scientific and technical studies and consultations

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LNG SOURCING EXPANDED FROM SIX TO 15 COUNTRIES

India approves Phase-II strategic petroleum reserve at ₹14,527 cr cost

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India is set to build the second phase of its strategic petroleum reserve programme at a cost of Rs 14,527 crore, with the government stepping in to fund up to 60 per cent of the project through viability gap funding under a public-private partnership model, the government said on Thursday.

The Phase-II plan, cleared in July 2021, will add 6.5 million tonnes of crude oil storage capacity. This will come from two new facilities, one in Odisha with 4 million tonnes capacity and another in Karnataka with 2.5 million tonnes, Minister of State for Petroleum and Natural Gas Suresh Gopi told the Lok Sabha in a written reply.

KEY POINTS

- » Government to fund up to 60% via viability gap funding, PPP model
- » Odisha facility to hold 4 million tonnes crude storage

The minister said the government keeps looking for new locations to set up more reserves. "Assessment of new sites for establishment of additional SPRs is a continuous process," he said. Unlike the upcoming phase, the first round of reserves did not need any government funding. Gopi said, "No Government Budgetary Support was provided for development and construction

- » Phase-II adds 6.5 million tonnes crude storage capacity, approved July 2021
- » Karnataka facility to hold 2.5 million tonnes crude storage

of SPR facilities under Phase-I." Under Phase-I, the Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserve Ltd (ISPRL) built storage facilities with a combined capacity of 5.33 million tonnes. These are located at Visakhapatnam (1.33 million tonnes), Mangaluru (1.5 million tonnes) and Padur (2.5 million tonnes). All three were completed between 2016 and 2018, and how much crude sits in these under-

ground caverns changes based on market conditions at any given time.

Gopi also revealed that ISPRL has signed a deal with the Abu Dhabi National Oil Company (ADNOC), letting the UAE firm use a 750,000 tonne cavern at the Mangaluru site. The two parties have additionally signed a non-binding memorandum of understanding for wider strategic cooperation, though the minister did not share further details.

On the broader question of energy security, Gopi said the government keeps a close watch on risks that could disrupt fuel supplies. He noted that India has widened its sources for crude oil from 27 countries to 41, while the number of countries supplying LNG has grown from six to 15.

Continued on P4

Kusha missile hits high-altitude target in 1st flight test

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) on Thursday successfully carried out the maiden flight test of the Kusha long-range surface-to-air missile from APJ Abdul Kalam Island off the Odisha coast, marking a major step in India's indigenous air defence programme.

According to the Defence Ministry, the missile was tested against an electronic target designed to simulate a high-speed, high-altitude aerial threat. The system successfully intercepted the target during the trial.

The ministry said the Kusha missile system is designed to engage a wide range of aerial threats, including fighter aircraft, missiles, unmanned aerial vehicles and large enemy aircraft across a broad range of distances and altitudes.



DRDO successfully conducted the maiden flight test of Long-Range Surface-to-Air Missile Kusha from the APJ Abdul Kalam Island off the coast of Odisha

PTI

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh described the successful trial as an important milestone for India's defence research and development. "The successful test-flight of

Continued on P4

Probe into clashes focuses on 400 Pak-linked social media accounts

‘Passports of those accused of rioting and unlawful acts may be cancelled’

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: Authorities investigating the violence suspect there may be a wider conspiracy behind the unrest, with misleading information circulated through social media, including accounts believed to be operated from Pakistan, playing a role in fuelling tensions.

Police said they had identified several Pakistan-based social media accounts that were allegedly spreading fake news and inflammatory content about the violence. So far, more than 400 such accounts have been flagged for circulating misinformation and provoking unrest.

Investigators are also examining who incited the violence on the ground and said strict action would be taken against those involved in rioting and other unlawful activities.

Authorities added that a drive to cancel the passports of those accused of



“The investigation is continuing, with officials analysing the digital trail and other evidence”

involvement in violence, rioting and other illegal acts would be launched.

The investigation is continuing, with officials analysing the digital trail and other

evidence. They urged the public not to share unverified information or rumours on social media and to rely only on official sources for updates on the violence and the situation.

Delhi Police deny protest-NSA link

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police on Wednesday rejected social media claims linking the Centre’s decision to empower the Commissioner of Police to invoke the National Security Act (NSA) with the ongoing CJP protests, calling such reports misleading.

The police said the Union government’s decision to authorise the Delhi Police Commissioner to order preventive detention under the NSA for three months, from July 19 to October 18, was a routine quarterly measure.

The National Security Act permits preventive detention for up to one year without

formal charges if the government or police deem it necessary in the interest of national security or public order.

“The notification empowers the Delhi Police Commissioner to exercise detention powers under the NSA for three months, from July 19 to October 18. It is not related in any way to the CJP protests and is merely a routine order,” the police said in a statement.

Police said the order was issued on July 7, before the CJP protests began, and took effect on July 19 as part of a routine quarterly renewal. It urged the public to ignore misinformation linking the notification to the protests.



People and security personnel gather near an overturned police vehicle during the protest, in New Delhi, on Monday

“ACP Vivek Bhagat said he was on his way to report for his evening shift when he and his team were surrounded and overpowered by a crowd near intersection of Tolstoy Marg and Sansad Marg”

and Sansad Marg.

“I was on duty in Sector 1, Zone 1, which includes the main Jantar Mantar area. I was on duty during the day and also had an evening shift.

“I was going to report for my evening shift from the Regal Building in Connaught Place via Sansad Marg. At the red light near Tolstoy Marg and Sansad Marg, I had a staff of five or six personnel walking ahead of me. An ACP probationer, Rohit, and my operator, Navneet, were with me,” he said.

Bhagat said the group realised that water bottles were being thrown at police personnel walking ahead of them and that the crowd was hooting and raising slogans against the police.

“As our police personnel moved back and forth, some of them moved forward to save themselves. One of them was overpowered by the crowd. Blood was coming out of his head and his entire face was covered in blood. I tried to intervene and rescue him,” he alleged.

Bhagat said the situation remained manageable as long as he was standing, but he was eventually knocked to the ground as the crowd swelled.

“Until I was standing, the

situation was still somewhat under control. But the crowd was so large that they brought me down. They started beating me, kicking me and punching me. A lot of abuses were hurled at me and the police were specifically targeted and attacked,” he alleged.

Bhagat said senior officers, including the DCP, eventually reached the spot and rescued him from the crowd.

He suffered head injuries, bruises and abrasions, besides bleeding from his nose. Two of his teeth were broken, while he also complained of stiffness in his jaw and pain in his knees and ankles.

Police sources said multiple clashes broke out during the protest, forcing security personnel to fire tear gas to bring the situation under control.

At least two ACPs and four other police personnel were injured in the violence, police sources said, adding that all the injured officers are in stable condition.

The sources also alleged that several “anti-social” elements had entered the protest site and were involved in the violence despite repeated announcements by police urging demonstrators to maintain peace and not disturb law and order.

YEIDA plans 8,000-hectare township near Noida Airport

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: The Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA) is planning to develop an integrated township across nearly 8,000 hectares between the upcoming Noida International Airport and the Tappal-Bajna Urban Node.

Originally conceived as an industrial hub, the project has been redesigned as a mixed-use city comprising industrial, residential, commercial and institutional zones. The proposed township will include housing sectors, schools, colleges, universities, hospitals, hotels, shopping malls and other civic amenities, creating a self-sustained urban ecosystem.

To take the project forward, YEIDA has invited bids from expert agencies to prepare a techno-economic feasibility report and the master plan. Interested firms can submit bids by August 5, while technical bids will be opened on August 7. The selected agency will have six months to complete the feasibility study, followed by four months to prepare the final master plan. Development work is expected to begin after the plan receives the necessary approvals.

In a separate decision, the Noida Authority has approved the induction of joint developers (JDs), where required, for stalled residential projects on the SC-2 plot of Sector 150 Sports City. The move is intended to help financially stressed developers revive delayed projects by bringing in fresh investment from other real estate firms.

Delhi Police suspend Additional DCP amid scrutiny of ‘Chalo Sansad’ rally crackdown

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Additional DCP Sandeep Lamba of the Delhi Police’s North-East district has been suspended from duty at the Jantar Mantar protest site after a video purportedly showed him assaulting a woman protester during the Cockroach Janta Party’s (CJP) “Chalo Sansad” rally.

The suspension comes amid growing scrutiny of the Delhi Police’s handling of the protest and criticism over its use of force during the march.

Lamba was seen in the viral video allegedly striking a woman who was protesting against Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan at Jantar Mantar on July 20. Thousands of CJP workers had gathered at the site before

‘Suspension follows the emergence of a video purportedly showing the officer striking a woman protester’

marching towards Parliament, demanding Pradhan’s resignation over alleged irregularities in the NEET examination.

The incident prompted former Trinamool Congress MP Saket Gokhale to file a police complaint against the officer. In a post on X, Gokhale said he lodged the complaint after the Delhi High Court was informed that no FIR had been registered against Lamba over the alleged assault.

“Yesterday, in the Delhi High Court, the government’s response to the petitions on police brutality was that no one had approached the police to

file an FIR. So today I have filed a police complaint,” Gokhale wrote. The alleged assault also came under scrutiny during proceedings before the Delhi High Court on Wednesday. Appearing for the petitioners, senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan referred to the video footage and argued that Lamba appeared to be assaulting a woman who posed no threat to him.

“The accused is not to be absolved of responsibility for his conduct as a police officer,” Sankaranarayanan submitted.

The petitioners further alleged that the Delhi Police

failed to follow standard operating procedures while dealing with the large-scale “Chalo Sansad” procession. They argued that water cannons, which are meant to be the first line of crowd-control measures, were not deployed, while tear gas was used despite being a measure of last resort.

Public interest litigations filed by Umesh Kumar and Anshul Kumar were heard by a bench comprising Delhi High Court Chief Justice D.K. Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia.

The court issued notices to the Delhi Police, the Centre and the NHRC, seeking replies within four weeks. It also directed the respondents to preserve all records, including CCTV footage and video evidence, related to police action during the protest.

Police deny lathi-charge death

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police on Thursday dismissed as false the social media posts claiming that a woman protester had died during police lathi charge at the CJP protest in the national capital and warned of strict legal action against those spreading misinformation.

New Delhi DCP Sachin Sharma said no protester has died during the protest and described the viral claim as “false propaganda” aimed at “creating panic and fuelling anti-police and anti-establishment sentiments.”

Police appealed to the public not to circulate unverified information and urged people to rely only on verified facts before sharing any

Inspector injured in attack

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police on Thursday alleged that Inspector Nand Kishor Singh was attacked and injured by protesters near Jantar Mantar while on his way to duty on Wednesday night.

Singh claimed he was surrounded by 100-150 people from a crowd of 4,000-5,000,

who assaulted him with sticks, stones and sharp objects while he was in uniform. Police said several personnel were injured during the clashes and action is under way to identify those responsible. Head Constable Balram also alleged he was stabbed with a sharp weapon. Police urged protesters to maintain peace and reject violence.

content on social media.

“Legal action will be taken against those who incite people by spreading such false posts,” Delhi Police said in a statement, adding that stringent action would be initiated against anyone found disseminating misleading or inflammatory content.

Police also appealed to everyone to remain calm, maintain peace and refrain from violence, saying misinformation could aggravate the law and order situation.

Senior officer meets injured cops

NEW DELHI: A senior Delhi Police officer on Thursday met police personnel admitted to the Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital after they sustained injuries as “anti-social elements” clashed with security personnel at Tolstoy Marg and Jantar Mantar on Wednesday night, officials said.

At least six police personnel, including two ACP-rank officers, were injured in the violence, they said, adding that security remained tight across the New Delhi and Central districts on Thursday in view of the large gathering of Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) supporters at the Jantar Mantar.

Special Commissioner of Police (Law and Order), Zone-I, Devesh Chandra Srivastava, visited the injured policemen at the RML Hospital and inquired about their condition.



Police sources said the investigation into Wednesday night’s violence has gathered pace, with officers identifying people involved in stone-pelting and attacks on security personnel.

“Many of those suspected of pelting stones appeared to be outsiders who infiltrated the protest, and efforts are underway to identify and arrest them using video clips, CCTV camera footage and other technical evidence,” a police source said.

Legal action would be taken against all those found involved in the violence, the source said.

The police assessment echoed the remarks made by CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke, who alleged that outsiders attempted to defame the protest by pelting stones at security personnel. Dipke said such incidents did not occur during their over a month-long protest, claiming that those responsible were trying to defame the agitation. *MPOST*

Unidentified woman found dead in field

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GHAZIABAD: An unidentified woman, believed to be aged between 22 and 25, was found murdered in a field in Ghaziabad’s Wave City area on Thursday morning, police said. Farmers spotted bloodstains, drag marks and damaged crops near Kazipura before alerting police. Officers found the woman, dressed in a salwar suit, with a fatal throat injury inflicted by a sharp-edged weapon. Four teams have been formed to investigate the case. Forensic experts examined the scene, while police are scanning CCTV footage and probing all angles, including honour killing and sexual assault.

Fast-track court announcement doesn’t address protesters’ key demand: Kejriwal

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal on Thursday said Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s announcement on setting up fast-track courts for paper leak cases did not address the protesting students’ primary demand for the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. In a video message on X, Kejriwal said this is not what the students had demanded.

Referring to Modi’s remarks made earlier in the day, the former Delhi chief minister said, “This morning, the prime minister announced that fast-track courts will be established for paper leak cases. What happened to Dharmendra Pradhan’s resignation?” The country already has fast-track courts for several matters, he said, and questioned their effectiveness.

Kejriwal said Modi did not mention incidents of students being injured during the protest march on Monday in his message to the youth.

Earlier in the day, Modi said the welfare of the country’s youth is the top priority of his government and asserted that anyone trying to harm their future will not be spared.

His outreach came three days after thousands of students, led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), marched to Parliament over alleged NEET irregularities. Police used lathi-charge and tear gas to disperse protesters, leaving scores of students and over 100 police personnel injured.

WEST DELHI: 917 VEHICLES TO STRENGTHEN WASTE MANAGEMENT

CM launches waste collection project

AIMAN FATIMA/
ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday launched the Door-to-Door Waste Collection and Secondary Transportation Project in the West Delhi Municipal Corporation area, flagging off a fleet of 917 waste collection vehicles as part of the Delhi government's push to modernise solid waste management through technology-driven monitoring and scientific waste disposal. The project will cover around 4.5 lakh households across 25 wards in West Delhi. It has been rolled out in six wards in the first phase, while the remaining 19 wards will be brought under the system by August 31, 2026.

Speaking at the launch, Gupta said the government's focus extends beyond waste collection to creating a transparent and citizen-centric sanitation system. "Our objective is not merely to collect waste but to build a modern, technology-driven, transparent and citizen-centric solid waste management system. The new system will make door-to-door waste col-



lection more efficient, timely and accountable while playing a significant role in creating a cleaner, healthier and more beautiful Delhi," she said.

The chief minister said the Municipal Corporation of Delhi had long struggled with inadequate resources, a shortage of waste collection vehicles and outdated infrastructure, affecting sanitation services. She said these shortcomings were now being addressed by replacing traditional dhalaos with modern compactor-based transfer stations. Gupta also urged residents to support the initiative by segregating wet and dry waste at source. "Building a clean, green and developed Delhi cannot be



“The new system will make door-to-door waste collection more efficient, timely and accountable while playing a significant role in creating a cleaner, healthier and more beautiful Delhi — CM GUPTA

achieved by the government alone. It requires active public participation. With modern technology, strong infrastructure and public participation, Delhi can become the cleanest and most well-managed capital in the country," she said.

The project includes a fleet of 917 vehicles, comprising 225 e-rickshaws, 550 mini tippers,

52 compactors, 41 hook loaders, 28 Tata 407 vehicles, 10 dumpers, six bin washers and 123 Fixed Compaction Transfer Station (FCTS) bins with a capacity of 1,300 litres. The government said the system would ensure 100 per cent door-to-door waste collection. Operations will be monitored through a GPS-enabled digital war room,

central control room, ESBM mobile application, CCTV surveillance and a dedicated helpline, aimed at improving transparency, accountability and grievance redressal.

Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood said the initiative would modernise the city's sanitation network and improve service delivery. "The Door-to-Door Waste Collection and Secondary Transportation Project marks a significant step towards modernising Delhi's sanitation system. Under the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the Delhi Government is committed to developing a clean, transparent and citizen-centric solid waste management sys-

tem. Modern vehicles, smart monitoring and improved infrastructure will provide better sanitation services to lakhs of residents in West Delhi," he said.

Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said the new system would strengthen waste collection across the capital. "Household waste will now be collected twice a day, once in the morning and again in the evening, instead of only once. Delhi is entering a new era of sanitation and waste management. Work to eliminate the city's landfill mountains is progressing at an unprecedented pace, with more than 70 acres of legacy waste already cleared," he said.

Mayor Pravesh Wahi said the initiative would promote scientific waste management and source-level segregation, while MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar highlighted the role of digital monitoring and modern equipment in improving waste collection efficiency. After the launch, the chief minister interacted with sanitation workers, thanked them for their contribution towards maintaining cleanliness in the city and shared a meal with them.

₹1 cr for hero's kin

AIMAN FATIMA



NEW DELHI: Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday handed over financial assistance of Rs 1 crore to the family of a frontline worker who lost his life while performing duty during the COVID-19 pandemic. The compensation, which had been pending for years, was released by the Delhi Government as part of its commitment to support the families of personnel who made the supreme sacrifice during the health crisis.

While presenting the cheque, the Chief Minister said the contribution and sacrifice of frontline workers who laid down their lives in the line of duty during the pandemic would always be remembered. She added that the Delhi Government remains committed to standing with their families and ensuring they receive the support they deserve.

Gupta said the assistance was not merely financial relief but a mark of respect and gratitude towards those who risked and ultimately sacrificed their lives while serving the people of Delhi during one of the most challenging periods in recent

history. She reiterated that the government is making efforts to clear long-pending cases and ensure that eligible families receive benefits without unnecessary delays. According to the Chief Minister, the welfare of families of frontline workers who made the supreme sacrifice remains a priority for the government.

The move is expected to provide long-awaited relief to the bereaved family and reflects the government's stated commitment to honouring the service and sacrifice of COVID-19 warriors. The Chief Minister said the dedication of frontline workers and the government's responsibility towards their families will always remain of utmost importance.



Metcalf House: Delhi gets permanent pump house

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Delhi PWD and Water Minister Parvash Sahib Singh on Thursday inaugurated a permanent pump house at the Metcalf House Regulator, aimed at providing a long-term solution to recurring waterlogging in the Civil Lines area during periods of high Yamuna water levels.

According to the Delhi government, whenever the Yamuna level rises, the Metcalf House Regulator is closed to prevent river water from flowing back into the drainage system. This also blocks the discharge of stormwater from the Civil Lines area, leading to water accumulation on roads, lanes and residential areas. Until now, temporary pumps were deployed every monsoon to address the problem.

Inaugurating the facility, Singh said the government has replaced the temporary arrangement with permanent infrastructure. "We have eliminated another major traffic and waterlogging problem in Delhi. Whenever the Yamuna water level rose and the Met-

calf House Regulator had to be closed, stormwater from the Civil Lines area used to backflow and accumulate on roads, lanes and even affect homes. Every year, temporary pumps had to be deployed. That temporary arrangement has now been replaced with a permanent solution," he said.

The newly constructed pump house has three 75 HP submersible pumps and one 35 HP submersible pump with a combined pumping capacity of around 2,500 kilolitres per hour. A 250 KVA diesel generator has also been installed to ensure uninterrupted operation during power outages, while an energy-efficient soft starter panel has been added for smoother functioning.

The minister said the government is focusing on permanent infrastructure instead of temporary measures to address waterlogging and flood-related issues. "We are identifying vulnerable locations, strengthening drainage infrastructure and creating long-term solutions that can protect residents during heavy rainfall and rising Yamuna levels," Singh said.

CJP protest: 17 Metro stations to remain shut for 3rd straight day

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: Seventeen metro stations in central Delhi will remain closed on Friday, marking the third consecutive day of closure, in the wake of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protest at Jantar Mantar.

The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) said late on Thursday that the stations will remain closed from 7.30 am on Friday until further instructions, citing security reasons.

The stations to remain shut are Lok Kalyan Marg,

Rajiv Chowk, Patel Chowk, Ramakrishna Ashram Marg, Barakhamba Road, Supreme Court, Seva Teerth, Janpath, Mandi House, Central Secretariat, ITO, Delhi Gate, Indra-prastha, Khan Market, Jor Bagh, Shivaji Stadium and Jhandewalan. The DMRC said interchange facilities will be available at Rajiv Chowk, Mandi House and Central Secretariat stations.

The very same stations remained closed for prolonged periods on Wednesday and Thursday due to secu-

rity arrangements linked to the protest, causing inconvenience to office-goers, students and other commuters in central Delhi.

On Thursday, entry gates of three stations — Central Secretariat, Mandi house and Rajiv Chowk — was opened late evening after around 14 hours of closure, while remaining stations remain closed.

Many passengers had to alter their travel plans, switch to alternate routes or rely on road transport amid heavy traffic congestion.

DU draws the protest line

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The University of Delhi on Thursday issued an advisory urging students and faculty members to refrain from participating in the ongoing protests at Jantar Mantar, cautioning that involvement in unlawful assemblies could result in legal action and have adverse academic and professional consequences.

The advisory, circulated to the university community, stressed that the institution's foremost concern was the safety and well-being of students and faculty. It reminded members of the university that demonstrations at Jantar Mantar are subject to regulations and restrictions in accordance with directives of the Supreme Court. The university cau-

tioned that participation in assemblies deemed unlawful could expose individuals to legal proceedings. It further warned that such involvement might affect students' academic records and future professional opportunities, urging them to carefully consider the implications before joining any demonstration. Emphasising the importance of maintaining discipline and a conducive academic environment, DU advised students to focus on their academic commitments and avoid activities that could disrupt normal university functioning. The administration also encouraged the university community to exercise caution and make informed decisions while adhering to institutional rules and applicable laws.

'CAN'T FIX THEMSELVES, AND THEY WANNA FIX THE COUNTRY'

Uniform, post... & controversy

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A social media post on Instagram by Sonia Sehrawat, a Rapid Action Force (RAF) Assistant Commandant, has sparked a political controversy after she mocked protesters from the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), who have been leading demonstrations in the post.

The controversy began when Sehrawat, who has a significant following of over six hundred thousand on Instagram, shared a story that many saw as an attack on the protesters.

The officer was part of the RAF's riot control team during the student protest march to Parliament earlier this week. She posted a picture of what looked like a dead cockroach with the caption, "Can't fix themselves, and they wanna fix the country." The post attracted immediate criticism online before it was deleted.

The CJP condemned the post, claiming it showed the officer's disrespect toward peaceful demonstrators.

In a statement on X, the party said, "This RAF offi-



cial actually sees the peaceful protesters as cockroaches and thinks the police brutality was justified because of that." They added, "But you see, we are cockroaches. And cockroaches never die!"

This incident occurs amid rising protests in the national capital. Thousands of students marched to Parliament on Monday during the start of the Monsoon Session.

The demonstrations escalated after police used tear gas and batons to disperse the



crowd. The situation has raised concerns about the conduct rules for government personnel on social media.

Current guidelines advise officers against making political comments or using personal insults, especially while performing official duties.

The rules also discourage personnel from using uniformed photographs as profile pictures on personal social media accounts.

Reports citing unnamed CRPF officers suggest that this

post might lead to disciplinary action. Some officials believe such public political statements by serving personnel harm the image of the force.

Despite the controversy, Sehrawat has built a large online presence by posting about her travels, fitness, religious visits, fashion, motorcycle rides, and motivational content.

Her account includes videos of beach trips, temple visits, interactions with students, and lifestyle posts that have garnered significant engagement.

The officer Sehrawat claimed that "rowdy individuals" and political party members had infiltrated the demonstration.

She stated that protesters threw stones, bottles, and other objects at security personnel and claimed she was injured while protecting women protesters.

With her arm in a cast, she also said some protesters scratched her, attributing her injuries to the violence.

Earlier, during a podcast, she discussed overcoming a severe training injury that required fifty-two stitches, describing it as a pivotal moment in her career.

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Where Development Values Nature

*Actual Photograph, Narela

'KASHMIR INTEGRAL PART OF INDIA'

‘Instrument of state policy’: India slams Pak at UN over cross-border terrorism

UNITED NATIONS: India has strongly rejected Pakistan's remarks at the United Nations, asserting that cooperation under the Indus Waters Treaty cannot be expected when "cross-border terrorism" is used as an "instrument of state policy".

India also maintained that Jammu and Kashmir "has always been, is, and will remain" an integral and inalienable part of the country.

The remarks were made on Wednesday by India's Permanent Representative to the United Nations, Ambassador Parvathaneni Harish, at the High-Level Open Debate of the UN Security Council on Natural Resources Governance: the Foundation of Peace, Security and Prosperity.

Responding to Pakistan, Parvathaneni said India was compelled to reply after Islamabad "misused" the discussion to push a "false narrative".



"Our position on the Indus Water Treaty remains clear and consistent. Cooperation on the basis of mutual trust and goodwill cannot be expected when cross-border terrorism is regularly deployed as an instrument of state policy," Parvathaneni said.

India's sharp rebuttal came after Pakistan's Permanent Representative to the UN, Asim Iftikhar Ahmad, accused New Delhi of "weaponising water" by placing the Indus Waters Treaty (IWT) in abeyance, calling the move "illegal" and

claiming it threatened the livelihoods of over 240 million Pakistanis.

The IWT, signed in 1960, is a World Bank-brokered agreement between India and Pakistan that governs the sharing of the waters of the six rivers of the Indus basin, allocating the eastern rivers to India and the western rivers largely to Pakistan.

India put the IWT in abeyance following the April 22, 2025, Pahalgam terror attack, saying cooperation under the agreement cannot continue in the face of cross-border

HIGHLIGHTS

» The remarks were made by India's Permanent Representative to the UN, Ambassador Parvathaneni Harish, at the High-Level Open Debate of the UN Security Council

» Parvathaneni said India was compelled to reply after Islamabad 'misused' the discussion

terrorism.

"As for the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir, it has always been, is, and will remain an integral and inalienable part of India. This is the constitutional and legal reality that Pakistan deliberately chooses to ignore," the Indian envoy said while exercising India's right of reply during the UN Security Council open debate.

"The only outstanding issue with regard to Jammu and Kashmir is the naked aggression and illegal occupation of India's sovereign territory by

Pakistan. Instead of pointing fingers at India, Pakistan would serve itself and its people far better by putting its own house in order," he added.

During his address, Parvathaneni said the "illicit exploitation and trafficking of natural resources can, in certain situations, contribute to the financing of armed groups and prolong conflict," but stressed that natural resources should primarily serve as an engine of development and prosperity for sovereign states.

He also highlighted that the primary responsibility for the governance and management of natural resources rests with sovereign states and called for transparent, accountable and nationally owned governance, along with responsible supply chains, greater transparency and stronger international cooperation to curb illicit exploitation of natural resources.

AGENCIES

Govt monitoring 2,485 glacial lakes in Himalayan river basins

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Centre on Thursday said it is monitoring 2,485 glacial lakes having an area of more than 10 hectares across the Indian Himalayan river basins using remote sensing techniques.

The government also said it has classified 56 glacial lakes as "very high risk" based on a scientific assessment carried out in 2025.

In a written reply to the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for Jal Shakti Raj Bhushan Choudhary said the Central Water Commission (CWC) monitors the glacial lakes across four states and two Union Territories during the period from June to October every year using remote sensing techniques.

He said the National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA), in collaboration with national scientific agencies, carried out a scientific assessment of 189 high-risk glacial lakes across the Indian Himalayan Region during 2025.

"Based on the assessment, 56 glacial lakes were classified

The govt also said it has classified 56 glacial lakes as 'very high risk' based on a scientific assessment carried out in 2025

as very high risk considering their potential to trigger Glacial Lake Outburst Floods (GLOFs) and the exposure of downstream habitations and infrastructure," the minister said.

Choudhary said based on the findings of the GLOF hazard assessments and glacial lake monitoring, the government has initiated the establishment of GLOF Early Warning Systems (EWS) at selected high-risk glacial lakes in the Indian Himalayan Region.

He, however, said that at present no end-to-end GLOF EWS has been commissioned under the National GLOF Risk Mitigation Programme (NGRMP).

The minister said the

NDMA is implementing the NGRMP, approved in 2024 in Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh at an approved cost of Rs 150 crore.

"The programme envisages Hazard and Risk Assessment, Monitoring and Early Warning Systems, site-specific structural and non-structural mitigation of measures, and community awareness and capacity building," he said.

Choudhary said Rs 52.50 crore has been earmarked under the Monitoring and Early Warning System component of the NGRMP.

He added that the NDMA, in collaboration with the Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation (SDC) and the Sikkim State Disaster Management Authority (SSDMA), conducted multi-agency expeditions to the high-risk South Lhonak and Shako Cho glacial lakes in Sikkim during 2023 and 2024 to facilitate scientific investigations and the development of appropriate monitoring, early warning mechanisms and mitigation measures.

From Page 1

Centre shifts higher education

the additional secretary in the Ministry of Rural Development.

The Ministry of Education has been at the centre of a controversy due to the alleged NEET paper leak and irregularities in the CBSE's evaluation of board exams.

Joshi has previously served as the director general of the National Testing Agency (NTA) and the chairman of the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE). He was appointed as the chief secretary in Manipur after the situation in the wake of an ethnic conflict escalated in the northeastern state in 2023.

The opposition has been demanding a discussion on the NEET paper-leak issue in Parliament and seeking Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation over the handling of the controversy.

MPOST

Rahul, INDIA

Then, we wanted to take them to Tees January Marg, Gandhi ji's assassination spot.

"Now, they have put this bus in front of us so that we can't get there. They put up this bus and barricades to stop us, preventing our movement. They are doing this drama.

"Obviously, they are scared. All of us MPs felt that if the students are on the streets, we should also be on the streets," Gandhi said in a video from the bus headed towards Gandhi Smriti.

In an X post earlier, Gandhi said, "Right now, MPs and leaders of the INDIA bloc are peacefully heading to Gandhi Smriti on Tees January Marg. We go to remember the students we lost – the children driven to take their own lives after the NEET paper leak."

"And we go to stand with the students who lie injured today – beaten for peacefully demanding justice and accountability. India's students are not alone. The entire Opposition stands with them and their demands," Gandhi said.

The opposition MPs earlier deliberated on their strategy to strongly raise the issue of alleged police brutality from the streets to Parliament.

The leaders present at Gandhi's residence included Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, general secretaries Jairam Ramesh and K C Venugopal, senior leaders P Chidambaram, Pramod Tiwari, K Suresh, Kumari Selja and Priniti Shinde.

RJD's Sanjay Yadav, Sudhakar Singh and Misa Bharti, CPI-M's John Brittas, RSP's N K Premchandran, TMC's Mahua Moitra and Saugata Roy, among others, were also present.

NEET fiasco

During Question Hour, Birla had asked opposition leaders to meet him to decide on the duration and date of the discussion on the NEET paper leak issue.

When the House was

adjourned for the day, Union Home Minister Amit Shah also had a one-on-one meeting with Birla. There was no official word on what transpired in the two separate meetings held at Birla's office.

When the Lok Sabha met at 11 am, Opposition members rushed to the Well protesting over the NEET paper leak issue and the police action on student protesters.

The Speaker urged members to let the Question Hour function, describing it as an important part of the day's business.

He said the government was ready to hold discussions on every issue raised by the opposition after the Question Hour and assured members that he would facilitate the discussions.

However, the Opposition members ignored the appeal and trooped into the Well of the House, raising slogans. With the protests continuing, Birla adjourned the proceedings till 12 noon, barely three minutes after the House met.

When the House reconvened, the opposition protests continued, leading to Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju accusing the opposition of attaching pre-conditions and trying to run away from a debate on the paper leak issue.

As the Opposition insisted on the resignation of Education Minister Pradhan, Rijiju told the members that during the proposed discussion, the government would also like to put across its point of view on the paper leak issue.

He said Opposition members can speak for as long as they want and the discussion can take place even for two days. Further, Rijiju said the date and duration of the discussion in both the Houses can be decided by the opposition.

According to him, the government has approached the Congress and other opposition parties on having the debate.

Amid the pandemonium, the proceedings were adjourned till 2 pm. After the House met again, the protests by the opposition continued.

Dilip Saikia, who was in the chair, urged the protesting members to maintain the decorum of the House and said that disrupting the proceedings was not correct.

With the loud protests continuing, the Chair adjourned the house for the day.

Similar scenes were witnessed in Rajya Sabha where opposition continued to insist on Pradhan's resignation before starting a discussion on the paper leak issue.

Rijiju said the government was ready for a discussion on NEET on Thursday itself and the opposition should not put any condition for holding the debate.

However, leader of opposition in Rajya Sabha Mallikarjun Kharge said Pradhan has to resign first before any discussion on the issue can take place.

"Today's statement by the Prime Minister is an instigative statement. Second, there has to be the resignation of the Education Minister. And then we are ready for the discussion," he said.

As both sides continued sloganeering, Chairman CP Radhakrishnan adjourned the House till 12 noon. When the House reassembled at 12 noon, Kharge demanded a statement from the government on Pradhan's resignation.

He said many students are in hospital due to police lathicharge and that their parents are extremely disturbed. He said the opposition is ready for a discussion, provided Pradhan resigns first.

Responding to Kharge, Leader of the House JP Nadda said the opposition's behaviour was highly irresponsible.

"They neither want any discussion nor let the House function. First, they told us to discuss the paper leak, and the government said we would discuss NEET and all other issues," Nadda said, as the Chairman adjourned the House till 2 pm.

As the House met for another time, opposition MPs, including Kharge, were on their feet, raising their demand for Pradhan's resignation. Deputy Chairman Harivansh said, "Today is the fourth day we should at least debate on the bill... Let the House function..."

As opposition MPs continued to be on their feet, he said, "You don't want to allow the House to function", and adjourned the House till 3 pm. As soon as the Upper House re-assembled at 3 pm, the Chair allowed Kharge to speak.

Kharge began reading poetic remarks from a written text, claiming that the opposition would take on any challenge in the interest of the nation.

Harivansh, who was in the chair, did not allow Kharge to speak further, saying he allowed the LoP to speak only to break the deadlock and start the discussion on the NEET paper leak issue. As the protests continued the House was adjourned for the day.

Manohar Joshi

regarding the examination system are genuine and must be handled with empathy and a desire to find a lasting solution," he wrote.

In a rare public intervention by a senior BJP leader, Joshi also criticised the police action against the protesters, saying it was distressing to witness young girls being "brutally mishandled". He said he hoped the protests would not be dealt with through the use of force.

"I fervently hope that this is not treated merely as a law-and-order issue to be tackled through the use of force," he said.

Joshi warned that such action could alienate large sections of Indian society from the national goal of achieving "Viksit Bharat", calling for a more humane approach to addressing students' grievances.

Wangchuk

which the Delhi Police stopped thousands of protesters from marching towards Parliament by using tear gas and baton charges. Protesters have also alleged the use of pellet guns and tasers.

MPOST

No ethanol in premium

with automobile manufacturers, oil marketing companies and research institutions.

The government has directed both public and private fuel retailers to supply petrol blended with up to 20 per cent ethanol across all states and Union territories under the Ethanol Blended Petrol programme. Ethanol-blended motor spirit with a minimum research octane number (RON) of 95 came into effect from April 1, 2026.

The minister said the government has not received any widespread or verified complaints from vehicle manufacturers, automobile associations or consumer organisations regarding E20 fuel. He added that laboratory studies, field trials and operational data have not shown any widespread adverse impact on engine durability, vehicle performance or vehicle life.

According to the government, more than 20 crore two-wheelers and over 3 crore petrol cars are already operating on higher ethanol blends without verified evidence of widespread engine failures linked to ethanol blending.

Rejecting any return to E0 or E10 petrol, Gopi said maintaining parallel nationwide supply chains for E0, E10 and E20 across more than one lakh retail outlets would increase logistics complexity, inventory and handling costs. "Having been scientifically validated and accepted by the automobile industry after extensive testing, there is no proposal to revert to E0/E10 petrol," he said, adding that the country's policy is to move towards cleaner and better fuel technology while balancing energy security, environmental sustainability and farmer welfare.

India approves Phase-II

"This diversification has reduced dependence on any particular country, region or transit route and enhanced India's ability to manage supply disruptions and market volatility," he said.

He added that the strategic reserves can serve as a cushion during sudden supply shocks. Alongside this, the government is pushing several measures to cut reliance on imported crude, including greater use of natural gas, CNG, PNG, ethanol, compressed biogas and biodiesel, along with improvements in refining and stronger efforts to boost domestic oil and gas output.

Kusha missile

Kusha marks an important milestone in Indian defence research and development," he said, adding that only a handful of nations possess the capability to develop such long-range surface-to-air missile systems. He said the system would reduce India's dependence on imports and represents a "giant leap" in the country's air defence capability.

The ministry said all major components of the weapon system, including the missile, radars and command and control centre, were developed by various DRDO laboratories along with industry partners.

Defence Secretary and DRDO Chairman Rajesh Kumar Singh monitored the launch activi-

ties and congratulated the teams involved after the successful flight test.

Wangchuk ends

action against paper leaks and we will try to pass it as early as possible," the Prime Minister said.

He said paper leaks had caused deep distress to students and their families across the country.

"I know that paper leaks are not a small issue and for lakhs of students and their guardians, such incidents are extremely painful," Modi said.

The Prime Minister said the government had acted on multiple fronts since allegations of the NEET paper leak surfaced around two and a half months ago. He said those responsible had been arrested and were in jail.

"Our most significant responsibility was to ensure that the students do not lose a year. It was necessary to hold the examination immediately. By using all resources, the government has ensured that 22 lakh students could attend the retest," he said.

Modi noted that the results of the NEET re-test were declared on July 19 and said reports of successful candidates celebrating had come from across the country. However, he said the government was not satisfied with only conducting the re-examination.

"That is why I have given directions to the authorities concerned to set up fast-track courts. The fast-track courts have already been established," he said.

According to the Prime Minister, the proposed legislation includes provisions for quicker trials and stricter punishment in paper leak cases. After the Cabinet considers the proposal on Friday, the government plans to introduce the bill in Parliament when the second week of the Monsoon session begins on Monday and seek its early passage.

The announcement came hours after the Delhi High Court decided to establish a fast-track court to deal with paper leak cases.

Earlier on Thursday, Modi had also addressed the controversy in a post on X, saying the future of the country's youth was his government's highest priority and warning that those responsible for harming it would not be spared. He said the planned fast-track courts formed part of a broader effort to safeguard students' interests.

The Prime Minister's renewed intervention came three days after thousands of students, mobilised by the BJP, marched towards Parliament demanding accountability for the alleged NEET irregularities and seeking the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

The BJP has been leading protests since June, demanding Pradhan's removal and compensation of Rs 1 crore for the families of students who allegedly died by suicide following the paper leak controversy.

Responding to Modi's late-night announcement, Trinamool Congress MP Mahua Moitra criticised the government in a post on X, saying, "Please @narendramodi ji go to sleep. Wake up at 4 am tomorrow & sack Dharmendra Pradhan."

The government has said it is prepared for a full discussion on the paper leak issue in Parliament when the House resumes its proceedings next week.

CJP intensifies nationwide

procedure (SOP) and a memorandum template while directing local organisers to obtain permissions and ensure peaceful demonstrations.

The nationwide mobilisation comes even as the protest at Delhi's Jantar Mantar continues to grow despite entering its second month. Far from losing momentum, the movement has witnessed steadily increasing participation, with thousands continuing to arrive at the protest site every day.

CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke sharpened the party's stance, warning that if Prime Minister Narendra Modi failed to secure Pradhan's resignation, the movement would eventually demand the Prime Minister's resignation as well.

He also criticised the government's response, saying that if authorities had invested as much effort in preventing paper leaks as they had in deploying police personnel, barricades and jammers, "22 young lives could have been saved." Dipke further said it took the Prime Minister 34 days to publicly respond to the issue, calling the delay "shameful".

CJP spokesperson Saurav Das reiterated that the party's primary demand, the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, remains "non-negotiable".

Earlier in the day, Dipke informed supporters that he was unwell and would remain away from the protest site for a few hours. "I've been down with a fever and severe body pain for the last few days, but I've been pushing through with painkillers. My apologies if you don't see me at Jantar Mantar today. I need to get a few hours of rest and recover. I will be back at the protest site by evening," he posted on X.

By Thursday afternoon, Jantar Mantar had reached capacity as thousands of supporters gathered at the CJP protest site, leaving volunteers to temporarily halt entry between around 2 p.m. and 3 p.m. With the venue overflowing, people were allowed inside only in small batches of five to prevent overcrowding. The crowd extended well beyond the protest site, spilling onto surrounding roads and stretching towards Connaught Place, Janpath Metro Gate Nos. 1 and 2, and the Gujarati Lane side, where food delivery personnel arrived with supplies in a show of solidarity.

Additionally, several students also alleged they were stopped or questioned by police near Nizamuddin while travelling to the protest site, with some claiming fellow students were detained. Police had not issued any official statement on the allegations till the time of publication.

Later in the day, the Union Home Ministry suspended mobile internet services within a 1.5-km radius of Jantar Mantar from 4 p.m. to midnight. Services on several sections of the Delhi Metro remained disrupted for the second consecutive day on Thursday, with 17 stations shut.

"Lok Kalyan Marg, Rajiv Chowk, Patel Chowk, Ramakrishna Ashram Marg, Barakhamba Road, Supreme Court, Seva Teerth, Janpath, Mandi House, Central Secretariat, ITO, Delhi Gate, Indraprastha, Khan Market, Jor Bagh and Shivaji Stadium metro stations have been closed till further instructions," the

DMRC posted on X.

The protest has also spread beyond Delhi, with demonstrations and solidarity gatherings reported from several states, including Bihar, Maharashtra, Goa and Rajasthan. CJP leaders described the movement as an "organic nationwide campaign" driven by students and ordinary citizens demanding accountability over the alleged NEET-UG 2026 paper leak.

Activist Sonam Wangchuk's wife, Gitanjali Angmo, said it was "deeply painful" to see students being portrayed negatively and questioned why it was "easier to question their intentions than to hear their concerns".

In a post on X, she appealed against linking the ongoing student protest at Jantar Mantar to incidents of violence elsewhere in Delhi without evidence, saying the movement had remained peaceful.

Delhi Police has maintained that force was used to enforce prohibitory orders and prevent protesters from marching towards Parliament, and has denied allegations of excessive use of force.

Police also denied having any plan of a crackdown on the protesters tonight at Jantar Mantar, dismissing claims made by former Delhi chief minister Arvind Kejriwal that security personnel could take such steps against them.

The New Delhi Traders Association (NDTA), citing the prevailing situation in and around the area, advised all offices, shops and restaurants at Connaught Place to close their establishments by 6:30 pm on Thursday.

Veteran BJP leader Murli Manohar Joshi also came out in support of the students. In a post on X, he said their "anxieties and concerns" regarding the examination system are "genuine".

Former Jammu and Kashmir chief minister Mehbooba Mufti addressed the protesters at the Jantar Mantar and praised the youths for enduring harsh weather conditions while demanding justice and transparency in the examination process.

Illegal constructions along Ganga River matter of concern, says SC

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Observing that illegal constructions along the Ganga are a matter of concern, the Supreme Court has directed the Bihar government to remove all unauthorised structures and encroachments between Nauzar Ghat and Nurpur Ghat in Patna along the river banks within six weeks.

A bench comprising Justices J B Pardiwala and K V Viswanathan noted that no steps had been taken by authorities to remove encroachments despite its earlier orders.

"We are informed that till this date, no steps have been taken to remove the encroachments. We grant six weeks to the State of Bihar to ensure that each and every unauthorised structures/construction and the encroachments are removed between Nauzar Ghat and Nurpur Ghat in Patna.

3,500 DETAINED AHEAD OF BANDH IN MAHARASHTRA

Paper leak protests rock several states; clashes erupt in Ranchi

NEW DELHI: Protests over the NEET paper leak and alleged police action against students spread across several states on Thursday, with Ranchi witnessing violent clashes between Congress and BJP workers, while demonstrations were held in Maharashtra and Assam demanding accountability and education reforms.

In Jharkhand, several people, including police personnel and journalists, were injured after Congress and BJP workers allegedly hurled stones, eggs and tomatoes at each other during a protest in Ranchi.

The violence erupted when Congress workers marched towards the BJP's state headquarters, raising slogans against Prime Minister Narendra Modi and demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over the examination paper leak controversy. BJP workers soon staged a counter-protest, triggering



Congress, BJP workers clash in Ranchi

PTI

Highlights

- » In Jharkhand, several people, including police personnel and journalists, were injured after Congress and BJP workers allegedly hurled stones, eggs and tomatoes at each other during a protest in Ranchi
- » In Maharashtra, the Prakash Ambekar-led Vanchit Bahujan Aghadi (VBA) organised statewide protests after calling for a bandh against the Centre's education policies

clashes despite heavy police deployment and barricading.

Police resorted to mild force to disperse the crowd. Ranchi SP (Rural) Gaurav Goswami said CCTV footage was being examined to identify those involved in the violence. Several people were detained, while both the BJP and Congress claimed around 10 people, including two journalists,

were injured.

In Maharashtra, the Prakash Ambekar-led Vanchit Bahujan Aghadi (VBA) organised statewide protests after calling for a bandh against the Centre's education policies, repeated paper leaks and the alleged crackdown on students in Delhi.

VBA supporters blocked a major road in Mumbai, dis-

rupting traffic, while demonstrations were also held in Nagpur, Pune and Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar. Mumbai Police detained more than 150 protesters for violating prohibitory orders before releasing them later.

Claiming that around 3,500 VBA workers had been detained across the state, Prakash Ambekar alleged

that authorities were targeting protesters instead of those responsible for the paper leaks. He also accused a section of the RSS of attempting to provoke confrontation with VBA workers.

Meanwhile, in Assam, students, parents, educators and civil society members gathered at Guwahati's Chachal protest ground to demand Pradhan's resignation and express solidarity with activist Sonam Wangchuk and students seeking education reforms.

The peaceful demonstration, part of a nationwide campaign led by Wangchuk, saw protesters carrying placards demanding transparency, accountability and justice for NEET aspirants. "We are here because students deserve a system they can trust. The NEET paper leak has shaken the confidence of aspirants across the country. We want accountability," a protester said.

‘Government depts sit on over 2K of CAG audit findings’

PAC flags prolonged delays across key ministries

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

Key Points

- » A total number of 2,491 audit paragraphs in the CAG's report were still pending for the submission of Action Taken Note (ATN) as on October 21, 2025

- » Out of these, 995 audit paragraphs were pending with the government departments and ministries for taking up the action, and 377 audit paragraphs were pending with the Audit Department for vetting comments

NEW DELHI: The government departments and ministries are sitting on thousands of audit observations, with the Public Accounts Committee (PAC) reporting a major compliance problem about the submission of ATNs (Action Taken Notes) on CAG (Comptroller and Auditor General) reports, according to the 51st report of parliament's Public Accounts Committee. The report estimated that a staggering 1,372 CAG audit paragraphs were still pending beyond the stipulated four-month period as of October 2025.

The parliamentary panel suggested, "2,491 CAG paras are pending for submission of ATNs as on date. Out of these paras, 1,119 CAG paras were added recently, and the prescribed time for submitting ATNs has not yet expired. 1372 paras are pending beyond the prescribed time limit. Out of 1372 CAG paras, 995 paras are

pending for action on part of Ministries/Departments for uploading ATN and 377 paras are pending on part of Audit for uploading vetting Comments."

Besides, the report further added, "Out of 2491 CAG paras, 1913 paras are pending for action on part of Ministries/Departments for uploading ATN and 578 paras are pending on part of Audit for uploading vetting Comments."

Hence, a total number of 2,491 audit paragraphs in the CAG's report were still pending for the submission of Action Taken Note (ATN) as on October 21, 2025. Out of these, 995

audit paragraphs were pending with the government departments and ministries for taking up the action, and 377 audit paragraphs were pending with the Audit Department for vetting comments. The maximum number of pending audit paragraphs was observed in the Department of Revenue of CBDT, followed by the Department of Expenditure and CBIC. According to the PAC, the delay in submission of ATNs creates problems for parliamentary supervision and compliance with corrective measures for identified deficiencies.

UTU scraps exams over leak; Cong demands minister quit

DEHRADUN: Amidst the nationwide uproar over exam irregularities, a case of an alleged paper leak has surfaced at Uttarakhand Technical University on Thursday, prompting the opposition Congress to demand the resignation of Minister Dhan Singh Rawat.

According to sources, following the incident, semester examinations for two subjects -- 'Machine Learning for Internet of Things' and 'Electromagnetic Field Theory' -- scheduled for the 2025-26 academic session have been cancelled by Veer Madho Singh Bhandari Uttarakhand Technical University (UTU), Dehradun.

They added that the examinations for both subjects will now be reconducted in the

Semester examinations for two subjects have been cancelled

third week of August, whose details will be made available to students on the university's website. According to the reports, the decision to cancel and reschedule the exams was based on the findings of the university's high-level inquiry committee -- constituted following a complaint about the 'Machine Learning for Internet of Things' paper leak -- and the report and recommendations of an internal inquiry conducted by Dehradun's Shivalik College of Engineering, an

institute under scrutiny.

Both the inquiry reports found that Ashish Kumar Gupta, an external teacher -- Assistant Professor at Shivalik College of Engineering and responsible for setting the paper for this subject -- had allegedly shared "similar questions" on the students' internal portal and WhatsApp groups before the exam, the sources said. Furthermore, an investigation revealed a possibility of a similar discrepancy and breach of confidentiality regarding the question paper for another subject, 'Electromagnetic Theory', which was also prepared by the same teacher, they said.

Gupta has been barred from all examination-related duties at the university. MPOST

Paper leaks, lathicharge expose govt failure: Priyanka

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Congress general secretary and Wayanad MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra on Thursday accused the Centre of suppressing student protests through internet shutdowns and police action, while holding Prime Minister Narendra Modi responsible for the examination paper leak crisis.

Questioning the Prime Minister's social media post expressing concern for students, Priyanka said security forces had used tear gas and lathicharge against protesting students the previous night. She alleged that the youth had lost faith in the system and would not accept any solution that sought to preserve the status quo.

She said the crisis could be resolved only if the govern-



Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and other MPs raise slogans

PTI

ment accepted the students' demands, including the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan and action against those responsible for the police action.

"If the Prime Minister takes credit for every achievement of the country and its people, then he must also take respon-

sibility for what is happening today," she said, claiming that 152 examination papers had leaked over the past 10 years without a single conviction.

"It is him who is getting people beaten up. Under his nose, 152 papers have leaked and there have been zero convictions. Who is responsible?" she asked.

Demanding accountability, Priyanka said the Education Minister must explain the repeated paper leaks, the Home Minister should answer for the use of force against protesting students, and the Prime Minister must clarify why no one had been held responsible for the recurring examination scandals.

She also criticised internet shutdowns around Jantar Mantar, calling them inconsistent with democratic norms, and

Mumbai cop shunted over 'plant drugs' threat

MUMBAI: The Mumbai Police on Thursday ordered a probe and removed a police driver from the duty roster after a viral video purportedly showed him threatening student protesters with false narcotics charges if they returned to demonstrate.

The incident sparked a fierce political backlash, with the Congress accusing the state government of indulging in "hooliganism in khaki" to crush democratic dissent.

Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis, who also handles the Home portfolio, condemned the policeman's act, calling it "completely wrong". He added that immediate action has been taken against him and the matter is being investigated.

In the widely shared 25-second clip, a police driver is seen telling two detained youths that they would face fabricated drug cases if they participated in further protests.

"If I find you here again, I will put 50 grams of 'powder' in your pocket. You won't get bail, and your entire life will be ruined. We are facing a lot of difficulties because of you people," the driver in the video reportedly told the students.

Taking serious note of the viral video, a senior police official said that an inquiry has been initiated into the matter.

"After verifying the facts, the driver concerned has been removed from his present posting till the completion of the inquiry," the official said.

The video drew sharp condemnation from the Maharashtra Congress, which demanded a high-level investigation into the conduct of the police force. Highlighting the clip on its official X (formerly Twitter) handle, the Mumbai Congress stated, "If this is true, it's not just an attempt to intimidate students, but a direct attack on democratic rights. Raising one's voice is not a crime. Students' questions should be answered with accountability, not threats." MPOST

Andhra CM launches blockchain pilot project for protection of land records

AMARAVATI: Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu on Thursday virtually launched 'Me Bhumi', a blockchain project on a pilot basis, aimed at offering "permanent protection" to land records.

Developed by the Revenue Department employing blockchain technology, 'Me Bhumi' will identify every land parcel with a digital identity to enable tamper-proof transactions with security, said an official press release. "Chief Minister Chandrababu Naidu virtually launched Me Bhumi from the secretariat," it said, adding that blockchain technology will eliminate the double registration problem.



N Chandrababu Naidu chairs a Cabinet meeting on Thursday

PTI

Due to improper land records, the CM said, cheating was occurring with respect to valuable lands, adding that land litigations are higher in Andhra Pradesh compared to Telangana. According to Naidu, land disputes inflated in Andhra Pradesh because of the alleged policies of the erstwhile YSRCP

government. Focusing on sanitising, security and other aspects, he said land disputes are being resolved, including state-wide surveys, cleaning up records and embossing pattadar passbooks (land documents) with the official seal.

Naidu noted that decades-old land disputes in Settyalli, Vattichekuru, Kangundhi and Gutupalli villages were resolved, underlining that the 'Me Bhumi - Blockchain' project will offer "permanent protection" to lands. With blockchain technology, the CM said Revenue, Survey and Registration wings will converge onto one single platform to undertake "issueless" transactions. MPOST

CJP protest lays bare Congress-AAP rift

Parties trade barbs as agitation deepens political divide

NEW DELHI: Tensions simmering between the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) and the Congress came to a head at the Cockroach Janata Party's stage at Jantar Mantar over charges of appropriation of the protest.

The interaction that made the faultline all too visible took place on Wednesday between an AAP leader and an activist perceived to be close to the Congress. The exchange, which escaped the cameras, captured the battle for political ownership of a protest that has emerged as one of the largest youth-led mobilisations in recent years.

For the AAP, which exited the INDIA bloc in June 2025, the Congress's support for the protest came too late and, more importantly, on terms that it believes undermined the agitation.

"The Congress, through its social media ecosystem, tried to damage the movement from the very beginning. When that narrative didn't work, they started saying there was no crowd and that the agitation was a flop. Once the movement acquired a life of its own, the Congress tried to take

In Short

- » The interaction that made the faultline all too visible took place on Wednesday between an AAP leader and an activist perceived to be close to the Congress
- » For the AAP, which exited the INDIA bloc in June 2025, the Congress's support for the protest came too late

it over," an AAP leader told PTI.

According to the leader, Congress supporters on social media initially sought to portray the campaign as "India Against Corruption (IAC) 2.0" -- a reference to the anti-corruption movement from which the AAP emerged.

The movement that contributed to the UPAs dethroning lies at the heart of the Congress-AAP distrust.

The Congress believes that the anti-corruption campaign enjoyed covert backing of the RSS-BJP.

The distrust only deepened after Arvind Kejriwal floated the

AAP, which ended the Congress's 15-year rule in Delhi in 2013, defeated it in Punjab in 2022, and emerged as a significant force in Gujarat with five Assembly seats and about 13 per cent vote share the same year. "Congress forced INDIA allies to send their second-round leaders initially. Then, once the movement gathered momentum on its own, they tried to hijack it. If they genuinely believed this was an AAP project, why did they later jump into it? I had an exchange of words with Yogendra Yadav, who advises the Congress, at Jantar Mantar yesterday," AAP leader Saurabh Bharadwaj said.

The AAP also thinks that the Congress created confusion at a crucial juncture of the agitation by trying to negotiate separately with activist Sonam Wangchuk, who joined the CJP-led protest and began an indefinite hunger strike on June 28.

According to AAP functionaries, the Congress persuaded Wangchuk to indicate that he would end his fast if political parties assured him that they would raise the issue in Parliament.

NEW DELHI: Former Jammu and Kashmir chief minister Mehbooba Mufti on Thursday expressed her support for the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) demonstrating against alleged irregularities in recruitment examinations, and described the agitation as a fight to safeguard the Constitution and democracy.

Addressing the protesters at the Jantar Mantar, Mehbooba praised the youth for enduring harsh weather conditions while demanding justice and transparency in the recruitment process, saying their struggle would discourage corruption, paper leaks and other injustices. The protesters led by the CJP have been camping at the Jantar Mantar since last month demanding accountability over the NEET paper leak and resignation of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, among others.

Calling it a defining



Mehbooba Mufti addresses students at Jantar Mantar

PTI

moment for the country's youth, Mehbooba alleged that the nation witnessed increasing incidents of "divide and rule" politics, exam paper leaks, corruption and crimes against women over the past several years. "This is what we have seen in the country for the last 12 years -- divide and rule. Sometimes 'chanda chori' (donations theft), sometimes paper leaks, sometimes rapes. Even cows are safer than children in our country today."

The PDP chief also criti-

cised the judiciary and the Centre, claiming that the concerns of the protesting students did not receive adequate attention despite their prolonged agitation. "Our judiciary says 'we don't have time for that'. So, if these people don't stand up today against this brutality, against this injustice, I think our country will become worse than it was in 1947."

"A change has to happen... These people (youth) will bring it. If we need to save the Constitution, these people will do it," Mehbooba said.

She also said that many parents spend lakhs of their hard-earned money to educate their children, and if the youth do not stand up against injustice today, the country will face serious consequences. Mehbooba also warned that if the Constitution is not saved today, those at the helm of affairs will turn the rest of the country into an "open jail". MPOST

पूरुषिया सभाहरणालय, पूरुषिया। (मधनियेध एवं उत्पाद विभाग)							
वाहनो की सार्वजनिक नीलामी हेतु अल्पकालीन सूचना							
एतद् द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि पूरुषिया जिला अंतर्गत मधनियेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 (यथा संशोधित) की सुसंगत धाराओं के अन्तर्गत विभिन्न मधनियेध थाना कार्डों में जप्त एवं अपर समाहर्ता-सह-जिला दण्डाधिकारी, पूरुषिया के न्यायालय द्वारा राज्यसात किए गए निम्नलिखित सारणी में अंकित वाहनो की सार्वजनिक नीलामी (Public Auction) सहायक आयुक्त मधनियेध, पूरुषिया के कार्यालय परिसर में दिनांक 12.08.2026 को 11:30 बजे पूर्वहन् न्से नीलामी समिति द्वारा की जाएगी। नीलामी में भाग लेने वाले व्यक्तियों को आवेदन आधार कार्ड/पैन कार्ड की स्वचिप्राणिगित छायाप्रति तथा अग्रघन की राशि का राष्ट्रीयकृत बैंक द्वारा निर्गत ड्राफ्ट जो Excise Superintendent, Purnea के पदनाम से एवं Payable at SBI Purnea (Code no 000159) में देय होगा, के साथ सहायक आयुक्त मधनियेध कार्यालय में नीलामी की निर्धारित तिथि से दो दिन पूर्व सूचना 5:00 बजे तक जमा करना होगा।							
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CRACKDOWN AFTER COP'S KILLING

J&K: Over 2,500 OGWs detained, two ‘terror-linked’ to houses razed

MPOST BUREAU

SRINAGAR: More than 2,500 suspected over-ground workers (OGWs) have been reportedly detained while two houses linked to “active” Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) terrorists were demolished, following the killing of a policeman in Jammu and Kashmir’s Anantnag, sources said on Thursday.

The action came hours after head constable Ashiq Hussain, who was deployed for Amarnath Yatra security, was shot dead by a lone terrorist at Lal Chowk in Anantnag on Wednesday. Officials said the houses of Adil Thokar and Haroon Rashid Ganaie, both active LeT terrorists, were demolished during the intervening night of Wednesday and Thursday as security forces launched a sweeping crackdown across the Valley.

The issue sparked a political debate, with Chief Minister Omar Abdullah cautioning against “wanton retributive action” and warning that such measures could prove counterproductive.

Abdullah said he understood the anger within the police force but stressed that punitive actions such as demolishing houses and carrying out mass detentions would not help restore peace. “I understand the anger of the police, but the Supreme Court has issued an order stating that summary action of this kind should not be taken,” he told reporters.

Recalling a similar crackdown after the April 2025 Pahalgam terror attack, Abdullah said some houses had been bulldozed then as well, forcing him to intervene with the Centre to stop the practice.



HIGHLIGHTS

» The action came hours after head constable Ashiq Hussain was shot dead by a lone terrorist in Anantnag

» The issue sparked a political debate, with CM Abdullah cautioning against ‘wanton retributive action’ and warning that such measures could prove counterproductive

He said investigations into the Pahalgam attack had later revealed that none of the attackers were local and all had come from outside Jammu and Kashmir. “Demolishing houses or making thousands of arrests will not improve the situation; in fact, it will only worsen it,” the chief minister said.

Drawing on his previous tenure as chief minister of the erstwhile state, Abdullah argued that security operations alone could not end militancy.

“We can reach a certain point using the police, Army and the CRPF, but the real end will come only when the general public stands together against such violence,” he said,

adding that people across Kashmir had condemned both the Pahalgam attack and the killing of head constable Ashiq Hussain. Abdullah said reports of large-scale detentions could alienate people and turn public anger against the system instead of the perpetrators of violence. “I hope we take our people along in this fight; only then will we achieve real success,” he said.

Peoples Democratic Party (PDP) president and former chief minister Mehbooba Mufti also condemned the killing of the policeman but criticised the government’s response, describing the demolition of houses belonging to “alleged” militants as “collective punishment” with no place in a democracy. In a post on X, Mufti said the killing of a police officer in the line of duty was a “heinous and condemnable act”, but argued that detaining over 1,000 people and demolishing family homes amounted to collective punishment.

She said that if the Centre believed militancy had been reduced to near zero, it should adopt a more humane and lawful approach towards innocent civilians instead of resorting to “tit for tat” measures against an entire community.

‘AT LEAST 41 DEAD, 70-80 MISSING’

Assam floods affect over 6.43L people

MPOST BUREAU

GUWAHATI: Assam’s flood situation remained critical on Thursday with over 6.43 lakh people affected in 10 districts, while incessant rains threatened to aggravate the situation as several major rivers are already in spate, according to an official report.

Union Home minister Amit Shah called up Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma to enquire about the situation, and said an inter-ministerial central team will visit the state within a day or two to assess the extent of damage in the deluge which left at least 41 people dead. Sarma said that 70 to 80 more people have been missing, and the toll is likely to increase.

With waters from NEEPCO’s Doyang hydel power project in Nagaland being released following increasing water levels there, the government machinery in Assam is bracing up for a further rise in flood levels late on Thursday.



Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma interacts with children during a visit to a relief camp in a flood-affected area, in Golaghat district

els late on Thursday.

The issue of devastation caused by the floods was raised in the Assembly for the second day, which saw Rajiv Dal MLA Akhil Gogoi being suspended from the House for the day after he climbed atop his desk while protesting the Speaker’s rejection of his adjournment motion seeking a discussion on the flood situation. An Assam State Disaster Management (ASDMA) report said that 35 revenue circles and

889 villages in the 10 districts of Charaideo, Dibrugarh, Golaghat, Hojai, Jorhat, Kamrup, Kamrup Metro, Karbi Anglong, Nagaon and Sivasagar continued to be affected.

More than 6,43,350 people are reeling under the deluge on Thursday. Over 6.53 lakh people had been affected by the floods in 11 districts on July 22.

The report said that 99 relief camps are operational, sheltering 24,596 people. A crop area of 24891.66 hectares also

Asian Pencak Silat meet: CISF athlete wins silver

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) athlete L/HC Nidhi created history by winning a silver medal at the 10th Asian Pencak Silat Championship 2026 held in Dong Nai City, Vietnam, from July 15 to 23. She secured second place in the continental competition, which featured top athletes from across Asia.

Attached to the CISF’s Central Pencak Silat team at the Airport Security Group (ASG), Delhi, Nidhi was praised for her dedication, discipline and outstanding performance. CISF said her achievement was the result of rigorous training and sustained support from its Sports Directorate, while ASG Delhi provided training,



logistical and administrative assistance.

Her success comes ahead of the 11th All India Police Judo Cluster Championship 2026, which CISF will host in Hyderabad from July 27. Pencak Silat is one of the five disciplines featured in the championship, alongside Judo, Taekwondo, Wushu and Karate.

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: Senior IAS officer Ashok Kumar Barnwal on Thursday took over as the 36th Chief Secretary of Madhya Pradesh. Outgoing CS Anurag Jain formally handed over the charge to him in the Chief Secretary’s chamber at the state secretariat.

Barnwal, a 1991-batch officer of the Indian Administrative Service (MP cadre), was appointed to the top bureaucratic post following orders issued by the General Administration Department (GAD) on Wednesday. The development came on the same day the Government of India appointed Anurag Jain as the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of NITI Aayog.

remained submerged.

Major rivers flowing above the danger level are Buridihing at Khowang (Dibrugarh), Dikhoul at Sivasagar, Disang at Nganglamuraghat (Sivasagar), Dhansiri at Numaligarh (Golaghat) and Kushiara at Sribhumi.

Multiple agencies, including the Army, Air Force, NDRF and SDRF, continued to carry out rescue and relief operations.

The CM, who was on a tour of the worst-hit eastern districts, said that the Union Home minister dialled him to enquire about the situation.

“I received a call from Hon’ble Home Minister Shri @AmitShah ji. In view of the unprecedented flood situation in Assam, he informed me that an Inter-Ministerial Central Team will soon visit the state to assess the extent of the damage, and help determine the Central assistance required for rebuilding livelihoods,” Sarma said in a post on X.

Mephedrone trafficking: ED arrests 3

NEW DELHI: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has arrested three persons in connection with a Rs 70 crore Mephedrone (MD) trafficking and money laundering case.

The accused—Ved Prakash Vyas, Dinesh Agarwal and Akshay Agarwal—were arrested by the ED’s Indore Sub-Zonal Office on July 21 in a case involving the alleged possession and trafficking of 70 kg of the banned synthetic drug. The money laundering probe was initiated after the Indore Crime Branch registered an FIR under the NDPS Act. The ED said the accused allegedly generated huge proceeds through drug trafficking and laundered the money via multiple personal and business bank accounts.

Searches in Indore and Mandsaur recovered documents, electronic devices and financial records linked to the investigation.

MPOST

Ashok Barnwal assumes charge as Madhya Pradesh’s Chief Secy



A highly experienced administrator, Barnwal was previously serving as Additional Chief Secretary in the Public Health and Medical Education Department. He has held several important portfolios during his career, including additional responsibilities in the Forest, Agriculture, and Environment departments.

An alumnus of IIT (ISM) Dhanbad, where he graduated in Mining Engineering, Barnwal brings with him over three decades of administrative experience across diverse sectors.

His appointment has been viewed positively in bureaucratic circles for his proven track record in policy implementation.

In a smooth transition, Jain, who steered the state administration for nearly one and three-fourths years, wished Barnwal success in his new role. The change at the top of the bureaucracy comes as the Mohan Yadav government continues to push key developmental and welfare initiatives across the state.

MPOST

B’luru: ED searches 8 locations in terror funding case

NARESH BISWANI

BENGALURU: The Directorate of Enforcement (ED) has conducted searches at eight locations in Bengaluru in connection with an alleged Islamic State (ISIS) recruitment and terror funding case, freezing proceeds of crime worth Rs 7.50 lakh and seizing electronic evidence linked to the investigation.

The searches were carried out by the ED’s Bengaluru Zonal Office on July 21 under the provisions of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002. The agency said it recovered incriminating electronic devices and digital data during the operation, while Rs 7.50 lakh suspected to be proceeds of crime was frozen in accordance with the law.

The money laundering probe stems from an Enforcement Case Information Report registered by the ED following the FIR filed by the NIA. The case pertains to the alleged ISIS recruitment activities of the Iqra Welfare Trust, Guidance for Mankind (GFM) Trust and several individuals based in Bengaluru.

The accused allegedly lured innocent Muslim youths into joining ISIS through programmes such as “Iqra Camp” and “Quran Circle”. The agency also alleged that funds were raised to facilitate recruitment and channelled through individuals, trusts and personal sources for the benefit of ISIS operatives in Syria via Turkey.

The ED said its investigation has found that funds mobilised by the accused and trustees of the Iqra Welfare Trust and GFM Trust were allegedly used to facilitate recruitment activities.

Sikkim tunnel mishap: Bodies of 25 workers retrieved after 72-hr ops

NAMCHI: The bodies of all 25 workers have been retrieved from an NHPC hydropower project tunnel under construction, which had collapsed in Sikkim’s Namchi district three days ago, officials said on Thursday.

Three of them were recovered during the day, they said.

The labourers were inside the NHPC Teesta Stage VI Hydropower Project tunnel that caved in following an explosion suspected to have been caused by methane gas shortly after 1 pm on Monday.

The state government has constituted a high-level committee to investigate the cause and circumstances surrounding the tragic incident and to recommend appropriate measures to prevent similar occurrences in the future, an official



Rescue operation underway after a tunnel collapse in Namchi, Wednesday

Rescue operation underway after a tunnel collapse in Namchi, Wednesday

Eleven of the deceased workers were from West Bengal, four from Jharkhand, two each from Jammu and Kashmir and Uttarakhand, and one each from Kerala, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Sikkim, Punjab, and Assam, another official said.

Eight of the 25 bodies have been handed over to their families, he said.

Eight of the 25 bodies have been handed over to their families, he said.

MPOST

‘BUREAUCRATS SHOULD NOT DECIDE COMPENSATION’

SC flags ‘systemic disadvantage’ to landowners under Highways Act

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Thursday observed that it was, prima facie, unacceptable for compensation disputes arising from land acquired under the National Highways Act, 1956, to be decided by government-appointed bureaucrats, saying the existing framework places landowners at a systemic disadvantage.

A Bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant, along with Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice V. Mohan, said the determination of compensation is a purely judicial exercise and should be undertaken by judicially trained adjudicators rather than administrative officers. The observations came while hearing a case involving a builder and the Central government.

The Bench noted that under the principal land acquisition law, compensation disputes are ultimately decided by a judicial forum, ensuring that a judicially trained authority determines the compensation payable. However, the National

KEY POINTS

» A Bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant, along with Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice V. Mohan, said the determination of compensation is a purely judicial exercise

» The court also pointed out that land adjoining national highways generally commands higher



market values, making fair compensation particularly significant for affected landowners

Highways Act departs from this framework by vesting the adjudicatory role in bureaucrats.

“The procedure under the principal land acquisition law ensures that the determination of compensation, which is purely a judicial exercise, is undertaken by a judicially trained mind,” the court observed.

It further remarked that the National Highways Act is the only legislation that creates such an exception by assigning

the role to bureaucrats. “Prima facie, that is not acceptable to us,” the Bench said.

The court also pointed out that land adjoining national highways generally commands higher market values, making fair compensation particularly significant for affected landowners.

Recalling earlier litigation, the Bench noted that farmers acquiring land under the National Highways Act had long been denied statu-

tory benefits such as solatium and interest until the Supreme Court intervened to extend those entitlements.

Chief Justice Surya Kant observed that while the Land Acquisition Collector under the general land acquisition law is a civil servant, the law provides an independent judicial forum where compensation can be reassessed. In contrast, he said, the National Highways Act lacks such a safeguard.

Attorney General R. Venkaramani informed the court that the Centre was actively considering amendments to the National Highways Act to provide for compensation disputes to be decided by a judicially trained forum.

Taking note of the government’s submission, the Bench said it would await the Centre’s policy decision before proceeding further. “We are only proposing the amendment. If the Government is examining the issue, we would welcome that... We can wait for some time,” the court observed.

AGENCIES

‘Robotic watercraft’ tested in Palghar

PALGHAR: A live demonstration of a ‘Remote-Operated Robotic Watercraft’ was conducted in Palghar district to make disaster management more effective and technology-driven, Collector Indu Rani Jakhar said on Thursday.

Jakhar, who is also the chairperson of District Disaster Management Authority, said the battery-operated robotic watercraft is designed to assist rescue teams in reaching stranded or distressed persons in water without requiring rescuers to immediately enter hazardous conditions.

The technology significantly reduces risks to emergency responders in fast-flowing rivers, floodwaters, and reservoirs, she said. “The battery-operated craft was tested in flowing river conditions to assess its manoeuvrability and remote deployment capabilities,” Jakhar said.

The initiative comes as the Maharashtra State Disaster Management Authority prepares to distribute these advanced rescue crafts across districts.

AGENCIES

Haryana to expand hepatitis care

CHANDIGARH: Haryana will establish 10 new Viral Hepatitis Treatment Centres under the National Viral Hepatitis Control Programme (NVHCP), expanding the state’s network from 26 to 36 centres.

Additional Chief Secretary, Health and Family Welfare, Sumita Misra, said the move will improve access to free screening, diagnosis, medicines and long-term treatment for Hepatitis B and C patients, particularly in high-burden districts.

The new facilities include one at ESIC Medical College and Hospital, Faridabad, and nine at sub-divisional civil hospitals in Fatehabad, Jind, Kaithal, Karnal, Sirsa and Panipat.

The Centre has approved support for all 36 treatment facilities under the NVHCP.

MPOST

plans to establish 250 Excellence Schools offering education in both Hindi and English mediums.

The chief minister said Mission Buniyaad and the Super 100 Programme are being implemented in 103 government schools.

Under these initiatives, 277

students have secured admission to premier institutions, including IITs, NITs and IIMs, while 61 students are pursuing medical education.

Saini also said the state has created a Department of Foreign Cooperation to facilitate overseas employment opportunities for youth.

MPOST

Nation Briefs

CBSE CENTRAL ZONE SWIMMING MEET: 8-YEAR-OLD MEHRANSHVEER BAGS BRONZE

NEW DELHI: Eight-year-old swimmer Mehranshveer Singh Tokas, a Class IV student of Delhi Public School, Vasant Kunj, won a bronze medal in the boys’ Under-11 50-metre butterfly event at the CBSE Central Zone Swimming Championship-2026. The three-day championship was held at the GNCTD swimming pool in Mangolpuri from July 17 to 19. The butterfly event is regarded as one of the most physically demanding swimming disciplines. Tokas trains at the DDSC Swim Club under coaches Mohinder Tokas, Sachin and Pankaj Rathi.



NFR ANNOUNCES SHRAVANI MELA SPECIAL TRAINS BETWEEN KATIHAR & MANIHARI

MALIGAON: To cater to the surge in passengers during the upcoming Shravani Mela, Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) will operate two pairs of special trains between Katihar and Manihari under the Katihar Division. Train No. 07540/07539 will run 22 trips each between July 25 and August 24, operating five days a week. Another pair, Train No. 07542/07541, will make eight trips each between July 27 and August 21, running on Mondays and Thursdays with return services on Tuesdays and Fridays. Both special trains will halt at Mansahi and Mahiyarpur, providing additional connectivity and easing travel during the festival period.



EDITORIAL
BLENDED
FUTURE?

Having achieved 20 per cent ethanol blending five years ahead of schedule, New Delhi sees E20 not as an experiment but as the country's new fuel standard. The Centre has also dismissed claims that the fuel damages engines, citing laboratory tests, industry data and the experience of millions of vehicles already using higher ethanol blends. The programme has undoubtedly delivered tangible benefits. It has reduced crude oil imports, generated additional income for farmers and lowered carbon emissions. Yet success in meeting a blending target should not close the debate. Public policy is not judged merely by whether targets are achieved, but by whether the trade-offs have been honestly acknowledged and fairly managed.

The government's defence of E20 rests on three pillars: energy security, environmental gains and rural prosperity. India imports nearly 85 per cent of its crude oil requirements, making the economy vulnerable to geopolitical conflicts and volatile international prices. Replacing a portion of imported petrol with domestically produced ethanol is therefore a sensible strategic objective. The policy has also provided sugar mills and grain producers with an additional market, improving liquidity in the rural economy. For a country that spends billions of dollars annually on crude imports, even modest reductions strengthen external stability. Few would dispute the broader objective of reducing dependence on fossil fuels through domestically produced alternatives.

However, good intentions do not exempt a policy from scrutiny. The government's repeated assertion that E20 causes no engine damage deserves independent verification rather than blind acceptance. Automobile manufacturers have generally stated that catastrophic engine failures are not occurring, but they also acknowledge that older vehicles not originally designed for E20 may experience reduced fuel efficiency and, in some cases, faster deterioration of certain rubber and plastic components over prolonged use. Consumers therefore deserve transparent, model-specific compatibility information rather than broad assurances. Many motorists are less concerned about laboratory tests than about their own repair bills. Public confidence cannot be built simply through official declarations; it must rest on continuous, independently verifiable evidence.

Mileage remains another area where official messaging has often appeared selective. Ethanol contains less energy than petrol, making a modest reduction in fuel economy scientifically expected in vehicles optimised for lower ethanol blends. While the government emphasises E20's higher octane rating and improved combustion characteristics, these advantages do not entirely offset the lower energy density of ethanol. For millions of middle-class families facing rising transportation costs, even a three to five per cent decline in mileage matters. Policymakers should acknowledge this reality openly instead of dismissing consumer concerns as misinformation.

The larger challenge lies beyond vehicles altogether. Ethanol is frequently presented as a green fuel, but its environmental credentials depend heavily on how it is produced. India's ethanol programme continues to rely substantially on sugarcane, a crop notorious for its intensive water requirements. States such as Maharashtra and Karnataka have repeatedly witnessed debates over whether scarce groundwater should support sugar cultivation in drought-prone regions. Diverting food grains for fuel production also raises difficult questions whenever inflation, poor harvests or food security concerns emerge. The answer cannot simply be that current production is adequate. Climate uncertainty means today's surplus can become tomorrow's shortage. A truly sustainable bio-fuel strategy must progressively shift towards agricultural waste, crop residue and second-generation ethanol rather than relying indefinitely on edible crops.

Nor should the economic claims surrounding ethanol escape closer examination. Government figures highlighting savings in foreign exchange and payments to farmers are significant, but they tell only part of the story. The programme has also required procurement incentives, infrastructure investment, interest support for distilleries and changes across the fuel distribution network. These costs are not necessarily unjustified, but they deserve the same public visibility as the reported benefits. An honest policy debate requires transparent accounting rather than selective presentation of favourable statistics.

Another concern is the narrowing of consumer choice. By indicating that there is no proposal to restore ethanol-free petrol, the government is effectively making E20 the default fuel for all petrol vehicle owners, regardless of the age of their vehicles. Such transitions may ultimately prove beneficial, but they should be accompanied by extensive public communication, clearer fuel labelling and practical support for owners of older vehicles. When governments mandate technological transitions, they also assume responsibility for ensuring that the costs of adaptation are not borne disproportionately by ordinary citizens.

The ethanol programme is best viewed as one element of a much larger energy transition rather than as its centrepiece. Biofuels can reduce import dependence and provide valuable support to the rural economy, but they cannot substitute for improvements in fuel efficiency, public transport, electric mobility or broader reforms in India's energy mix. Excessive reliance on any single solution risks creating new economic and environmental vulnerabilities while solving old ones.

India deserves credit for pursuing greater energy self-reliance through innovation rather than inertia. But self-reliance should never become a reason to discourage scrutiny. Policies affecting hundreds of millions of vehicles, farmers and consumers must remain open to independent evaluation, scientific evidence and public feedback. E20 may well represent an important step towards a cleaner and more secure energy future. Whether it becomes a durable success, however, will depend less on achieving a numerical blending target than on ensuring that environmental sustainability, consumer welfare and agricultural priorities advance together rather than at one another's expense.

BHARAT
KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS
CHAIRPERSON,
BHARAT KI SOCH

Arjun teaches us that wisdom begins when leaders recognise the complexity of a choice before rushing to simplify it

GROUND
REALITY



SANKAR RAJAN

THE WRITER IS A
DISTINGUISHED
PHYSICIAN AND
PUBLIC HEALTH
NUTRITION EXPERT

NFHS-6 suggests that India's nutrition challenge is changing rather than disappearing

Beyond the Bird's Eye

From focus and discipline to humility and moral clarity, Arjun offers enduring lessons for individuals, institutions and corporate leaders

He did not falter because he lacked skill. He faltered because, at the decisive moment, he no longer knew whether he should fight at all. At Kurukshetra, Arjun stood as one of the greatest warriors of his age. He had trained relentlessly, mastered extraordinary weapons and proved his courage repeatedly. Yet when he saw teachers, relatives, friends and elders standing across the battlefield, his certainty collapsed. The bow remained in his hand, but the purpose behind it had become unclear.

That moment defines Arjun more powerfully than any victory. It shows that the greatest crisis of a capable person is not always the absence of competence. Sometimes it is the inability to decide how competence should be used. His story offers a powerful cultural framework for life and leadership: focus before action, character before competence, duty before recognition, reflection before decision and purpose before victory.

Arjun is remembered for his discipline and concentration. Under Dronacharya, when the students were asked what they could see while aiming at a wooden bird, others described the tree, its branches and the surrounding scene. Arjun saw only the bird's eye. Focus is not simply the ability to ignore distraction. It is the ability to identify what truly matters.

People and organisations can remain busy without advancing a meaningful purpose. Leaders can pursue numerous priorities, teams can meet targets and institutions can display impressive efficiency, yet still lose sight of the larger objective. Arjun teaches us the value of focus before action. His later crisis adds an equally important warning: it is not enough to hit the target. One must first ask whether the target is right.

His excellence was not a product of talent alone. Arjun practised, observed and continued learning even after distinguishing himself from others. His discipline reminds us that natural ability creates potential, but sustained effort converts it into mastery. Excellence is built through repetition, correction and patience long before it is publicly recognised.

Yet competence by itself was never enough. Arjun also needed humility. On the battlefield, he accepted Krishna not merely as his charioteer, but as his guide. He possessed the weapons and training, but recognised that moral clarity and strategic wisdom could come from someone who was not holding the bow. True confidence does not reject counsel. It knows when counsel is necessary.

This willingness to seek guidance



Arjun's crisis at Kurukshetra was not a failure of courage or competence. It was a confrontation with purpose

is vital in positions of authority. Success can create the illusion that expertise in one area amounts to wisdom in every area. A leader may understand finance, operations, technology or markets and still misjudge people, consequences or purpose. Arjun reminds us that the higher a person rises, the more important it becomes to remain open to honest advice. Great leaders do not surround themselves only with agreement. They make room for those who can challenge assumptions and reveal what power may fail to see.

Arjun, however, was not flawless. His hesitation arose not only from moral reflection, but also from grief and attachment. He also experienced pride, anger and emotional conflict. He depended deeply on Krishna to regain clarity. These qualities make his journey more human and instructive. Great leaders are not those who have no weaknesses. They are those who recognise that they still have room to grow.

His dependence on Krishna showed that even extraordinary individuals may struggle to resolve moral uncertainty alone. His growth began when he stopped treating confusion as something to hide and examined it honestly. Wisdom often begins where certainty ends.

Arjun's crisis offers a powerful lesson in decision-making under uncertainty. Leaders rarely possess complete information. They must choose between competing responsibilities, imperfect alternatives and consequences that cannot be fully predicted. Leadership is seldom the art of selecting between an obviously right path and an obviously wrong one. More often, it is the art of choosing between difficult options, each carrying a cost.

In such moments, haste can be as dangerous as paralysis. Some leaders rush into action because decisiveness

creates an appearance of strength. Others delay endlessly because analysis becomes a refuge from responsibility. Arjun offers a more balanced path: pause, question, seek wisdom, understand the consequences and then act with conviction. Reflection before decision is not weakness. It protects judgment from fear, ego, anger and personal advantage.

Arjun teaches us that wisdom begins when leaders recognise the complexity of a choice before rushing to simplify it. Moral discomfort should not always be silenced. It may be the conscience warning that the human consequences of a decision have not been fully considered. At the same time, reflection must eventually lead to responsibility. Through Krishna's counsel, Arjun understood that withdrawing from action would not automatically make him righteous. Duty could not be abandoned simply because it had become painful.

This is where character becomes more important than competence. Skill may win admiration, but character determines how skill is used. Arjun's task was not merely to fight. It was to act without hatred, greed or attachment to reward and to place duty above recognition. The lesson is not that every difficult battle must be fought, but that every major decision must be examined through purpose, responsibility and consequence.

His years of exile reveal another dimension of this lesson. During the Pandavas' final year in concealment, Arjun lived as Brihannala and taught dance and music in the court of Virat. A celebrated warrior accepted anonymity, entered an unfamiliar role and contributed without demanding recognition. He showed that identity need not depend on title, status or public

approval. This has direct relevance for professional life. Some leaders struggle when circumstances require them to step back, learn a new function or serve without authority. Arjun demonstrated that genuine capability survives a change of role. Leadership is not always expressed through command. It can also appear through teaching, patience, restraint and preparation. Duty before recognition means continuing to contribute even when applause is absent.

Modern institutions face Kurukshetras of their own. They must balance performance with long-term sustainability, technological capability with ethical judgment, speed with reflection and competition with responsibility. A profitable decision may weaken public trust. A powerful technology may create consequences that were never adequately considered. A short-term victory may damage the institution itself.

Corporate leadership therefore requires more than the ability to deliver results. It requires the wisdom to ask what those results serve, who bears their cost and whether they can be sustained with integrity. Purpose before victory means refusing to measure success only through immediate gain. Ethical leadership begins when performance remains answerable to conscience.

Arjun's achievements were never his alone. Krishna's guidance, the solidarity of his brothers, the support of allies and the cause to which he belonged all shaped his journey. His story challenges the idea of the completely self-made achiever. Individual brilliance becomes meaningful only when aligned with collective purpose. The finest archer still needed a charioteer, a teacher, a team and a cause.

For individuals, Arjun teaches discipline, focus, humility and the courage to question oneself. For institutions, he shows that capability must remain guided by character. For corporate leaders, he demonstrates that uncertainty cannot be eliminated, but it can be approached with reflection, counsel and moral clarity. His greatness did not lie in never doubting. It lay in his willingness to examine doubt and return to duty with deeper understanding.

Every generation has its own Kurukshetra. Technologies advance, markets change and institutions evolve, but the fundamental question remains unchanged: are we guided by purpose, or driven by expedience? Arjun reminds us that greatness is measured not by the precision of our arrows, but by the wisdom with which we choose our aim.

Views expressed are personal

Periodic Alarm to Sustained Action

The debate over NFHS-6 should move beyond headline indicators and focus on the harder questions of implementation, quality of public services and the country's emerging double burden of malnutrition

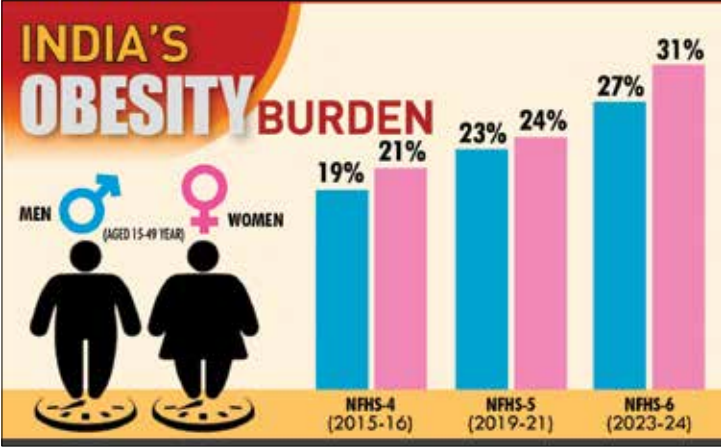
The release of the National Family Health Survey-6 (NFHS-6) factsheets has, as expected, triggered a familiar wave of commentary across print, digital, and social media. Graphics highlighting stunting, wasting, underweight prevalence, and the triple burden of malnutrition—including overnutrition and micronutrient deficiencies—have dominated the discourse. Many voices rightly express concern over remaining gaps. Others question survey methodologies. Yet, conspicuously missing in much of the coverage is a balanced acknowledgment of the genuine progress India has made over the past decades.

This cyclical pattern—intense scrutiny every few years when a major dataset drops, followed by relative silence until the next round—does a disservice to both understanding and action. Nutrition and child health outcomes deserve rigorous public debate and accountability. But treating each NFHS release as a fresh verdict on national failure overlooks the longer arc of improvement and distracts from what truly determines results on the ground.

India's Remarkable, if Uneven, Progress

NFHS-6 shows continued gains. Stunting among children under five has declined from 35.5% in NFHS-5 to 29.3%. Severe wasting has dropped from 7.7% to 5.2%. Institutional deliveries have reached over 90%, vaccination coverage has improved further, and key maternal and child health indicators reflect better access to services.

These improvements build on longer trends: steady reductions in Infant Mortality Rate (IMR), Neonatal Mortality Rate (NMR), and Under-Five Mortality Rate (U5MR) over multiple survey rounds. Disparities between states, rural-urban areas, and socio-economic groups persist, but many gaps are narrowing. This is not accidental. It reflects decades of investment in infrastructure, policy frameworks, and programmatic architecture.



India has built one of the world's largest community-based delivery systems: Anganwadi workers, ASHAs, and auxiliary nurse midwives form a massive frontline force. Flagship initiatives like the Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS), Poshan Abhiyaan, and others are evidence-informed, multi-sectoral, and backed by significant budgetary support. Science has clarified what works—timely breastfeeding, complementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, sanitation, maternal nutrition, and infection control—and these are embedded in national strategies.

The Emerging Double Burden While progress on undernutrition continues, NFHS-6 also reveals a concerning rise in the other side of the malnutrition spectrum. The prevalence of overweight or obesity among women aged 15-49 has increased from 24% in NFHS-5 to 30.7%, and among men from 22.9% to 27.3%. High blood sugar levels—a precursor to diabetes—have also risen sharply, alongside hypertension. This shift, driven by changing dietary patterns, increased consumption of processed foods, and declining physical activity, signals India's growing double burden of malnutrition.

Addressing overnutrition and associated non-communicable diseases is far more complex than undernutrition. It demands systemic transformations in our food systems, food environments, urban planning, and behavioural norms—areas where India's programmatic experience is still evolving. This emerging challenge underscores the need for innovative, multi-sectoral strategies even as we strengthen ongoing efforts against undernutrition.

The Real Challenge: Implementation with Equity and Quality

The persistent burden of malnutrition, especially among the most vulnerable, is real. But the core issue today is less about knowing what to do or lacking policy scaffolding, and more about how we implement at scale.

Too often, the conversation stops at outcome indicators from household surveys. We debate percentages while paying insufficient attention to three critical dimensions. First, we must achieve universal coverage with a strong equity lens, reaching the last mile in remote, tribal, urban slum, and poorest households where burdens remain highest. Second, we need uncompromising quality of delivery—ensuring supplementary nutri-

tion is nutritious and timely, growth monitoring is accurate and followed by action, counselling leads to genuine behaviour change, and services go beyond nominal checkboxes. Third, we require robust process monitoring and course correction through regular tracking of coverage rates, service quality, supply chains, and frontline worker performance, enabling rapid adjustments where needed.

Desk reviews and media critiques of published datasets are necessary for accountability but insufficient on their own. Real, sustained improvement demands continuous, ground-level engagement.

A Call for Collective Responsibility

Civil society, academia, media, and citizens have vital roles beyond critiquing every new survey. We must channel our energy toward supporting and strengthening implementation in four key ways. We should demand and actively monitor saturation coverage in high-burden areas. We must advocate for reliable, data-driven process indicators at district and block levels. We need to partner with governments to strengthen training, supervision, and community feedback loops. And we should celebrate incremental wins publicly to build momentum and political will for harder reforms.

India has successfully constructed the scaffolding for a nourished generation. The task now is to ensure every pillar is strong, every rung reaches the bottom, and the structure is maintained with relentless focus on quality and equity.

Periodic data releases should not reset the conversation to zero. They should serve as milestones on a longer journey—one where we learn to acknowledge progress, maintain urgency about unfinished tasks, and direct collective energy into the hard, unglamorous work of implementation. Our children's futures depend less on sharper headlines and more on steadier, more equitable delivery of what we already know works.

Views expressed are personal

US military carries out strikes on Iran

Both sides threaten civilian infrastructure



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

DUBAI: The US military announced Wednesday that it was conducting a 12th night of strikes against Iran as both sides increasingly targeted civilian infrastructure.

US Central Command said the attacks were designed to “further degrade Iran’s ability to threaten civilian mariners and commercial vessels transiting regional waters,” as the Americans push to regain control over the Strait of Hormuz and restore the flow of international shipping.

President Donald Trump warned earlier Wednesday that the US would destroy one bridge or power plant each time Iran shoots at a ship in the Strait.

“From this point forward, any time the Islamic Republic of Iran shoots at a ship in the Strait of Hormuz, whether it be by Missile, Rocket, Drone, or any other device or weapon, the United States will bomb and destroy ONE BRIDGE OR POWER PLANT,” Trump

Highlights

- » The attack occurred even as diplomatic efforts show little public sign of progress
- » Iran’s foreign minister said his country would adopt an ‘eye for an eye’ defense doctrine

wrote on social media.

The continued American airstrikes are occurring even as diplomatic efforts show little public sign of progress and officials on both sides have dug in on the dispute over the crucial waterway for global energy that remains largely closed. The unpopular war threatens further worldwide economic disruption and is sending fuel prices up ahead of midterm US elections this fall.

Seyed Abbas Araghchi, Iran’s foreign minister, said his country would adopt an “eye for an eye” defense doctrine.

“Any aggression against Iran, including our infrastructure, will compel a powerful and decisive response,” he posted Wednesday on X.

Iranian state media reported that US missiles struck locations late Wednesday near the cities of Ahvaz, Ramshir and Andimeshk in western Iran. Two people were killed in a US missile strike in the town of Shalamchah on the Iraqi boarder, Iranian state media said early Thursday.

Meanwhile, military officials in Kuwait said on social media that their air defences were “confronting attacks by hostile drones, following the sinful Iranian aggression.”

Iran has responded to US attacks by targeting energy infrastructure and desalination plants that provide drinking water in parched neighbouring Gulf countries.

International law generally prohibits such attacks unless the infrastructure is being used for military purposes. AGENCIES

Houthi attack Saudi tankers in Red Sea, threatening to widen Iran war

CAIRO: Yemen’s Iran-backed Houthi rebels said they attacked two Saudi oil tankers in the Red Sea on Thursday, potentially opening a new front as the US military conducted its 12th night of strikes against Iran.

The Houthis have threatened to shut down another key trade route, with the world economy already reeling from Iran’s closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

Iran and the US have meanwhile stepped up their attacks as they vie for control of the strait, through which a fifth of the world’s oil and gas passed in peacetime, setting off a scramble for alternative routes.

US President Donald



Trump threatened “major military punishment” against the Houthis if their attacks on ships continue.

“If they do this again, the US will hold Iran responsible, in that the Houthis are a Surrogate and/or Proxy of Iran, and major military punishment

will be inflicted upon Iran and, of course, the Houthis themselves,” Trump wrote on social media.

As the rhetoric escalated, so did the economic fallout.

The price of a barrel of Brent crude oil, the international standard, spiked 4.3 per cent Thursday to \$98.16, its highest level since early June, before the two sides reached a preliminary peace agreement that has since collapsed.

Prime Minister Ali al-Zaidi of Iraq, who has close ties to both the US and Iran, was in Tehran on Thursday to call for peace and dialogue, a spokesperson said. Al-Zaidi met with Trump earlier this month in Washington. AGENCIES

PAK ARMY CHIEF SAYS ‘Targeted action against terrorists will continue’

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan’s Chief of Army Staff Field Marshal Syed Asim Munir on Thursday said targeted action against terrorists would continue until their complete elimination.

He made these remarks during an interaction with participants of the 20th National Workshop Balochistan at General Headquarters, Rawalpindi, according to a statement by the army. Addressing the participants, Munir said that consistent efforts of security forces and law enforcement agencies, backed by the support of people, would bring lasting peace to Balochistan.

“Targeted operations against Fitna al Khawarij and Fitna al Hindustan would continue with full resolve until the menace of terrorism and its abettors are eliminated from Pakistan,” he said. Fitna al Khawarij is a term used for the Teh-

He made these remarks during an interaction with participants of the 20th National Workshop Balochistan

reek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP) terrorists while Fitna al Hindustan refers to terrorists active in Balochistan.

India has slammed Islamabad’s decision to refer to groups inside its own borders as ‘Fitna al-Hindustan’ as nothing but “officially sponsored misinformation and disinformation dressed in religious terminology.” The field marshal reiterated Pakistan’s resolve to dismantle terrorist infrastructure wherever it poses a threat to the country and its people, the statement said. AGENCIES

China begins two days of live-fire drills in Taiwan Strait

BEIJING: China began two days of live-fire drills from Thursday in some parts of the Taiwan Strait near the shores of its southeastern province of Fujian.

The news comes a day after talks between U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi on a range of issues, including democratically governed Taiwan, which China claims as its own territory.

The drills will run from 6.00 a.m. to 6 p.m. (2200 GMT to 1000 GMT) each day around Dongshan Island, bordering the province of Guangdong, maritime authorities said in a notice.

Taiwan’s foreign ministry on Thursday condemned China’s actions and called on Beijing to exercise “rational self-restraint.” AGENCIES

Saudi nuclear pact requires to normalise Israel relations: Trump



US President Donald Trump

WASHINGTON: President Donald Trump said Thursday that a new agreement reached with Saudi Arabia for a civilian nuclear program will require the kingdom to normalise relations with Israel through the Abraham Accords.

In a post on social media, the Republican president said the deal does not allow for enrichment of uranium. Non-proliferation experts have raised concerns that the deal fails to include guardrails to prevent enrichment of uranium to weapons-grade levels.

Trump’s post said the agreement “will be approved, but is totally subject to Saudi Arabia joining the very respected and successful Abraham Accords.” He added that the US “is not opposed to Civil (Non-Enriched) Nuclear Facilities.”

The Saudis have made clear that normalising relations with Israel would first require the establishment of a clear path for Palestinian statehood. Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu has rejected the idea of Palestinian statehood as being untenable for his country’s security. The Saudi Embassy in Washington declined to comment Thursday on Trump’s assertion that the deal will require the kingdom to join the accords.

Netanyahu’s office, in a

Key Points

- » The Saudis have made clear that normalising relations with Israel would first require the establishment of a clear path for Palestinian statehood
- » Israeli PM Benjamin Netanyahu has rejected the idea of Palestinian statehood as being untenable for his country’s security

THE NEW NUCLEAR DEAL ANNOUNCED IS EXPECTED TO LAST 30 YEARS AND INVOLVE US FIRMS IN THE PROGRAM’S DEVELOPMENT

statement, applauded the prospect of Saudi Arabia joining the accords as a “historic leap forward for peace in the Middle East.”

The statement made no mention of the deal to bolster Saudi Arabia’s civil nuclear program.

Trump has sought to build on the 2020 agreements, which expanded the number of Arab and Muslim-majority nations with diplomatic ties with Israel. AGENCIES

NORTHERN RAILWAY
1st CORRIGENDUM
Tender No.: 95-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27
Name of Work: "Rewiring of Railway Quarters in the jurisdiction of SSE/PS/SSB"
The amendments in above said tender are as under:
Tender No:- 95-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27
Earlier published Amended
Name of work 95-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27
"Rewiring of Railway Quarters in the jurisdiction of SSE/PS/SSB"
Approx cost of the works in Rs. 1144640.00/-
Address of the office Sr.Div.Elect.Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055
Cancelled due to administrative ground
Bid Security Rs. 228900.00/-
Date & time of submission of tender 31/07/2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender 31/07/2026, 16.00 Hrs.
The tender document of above-mentioned tender has been modified kindly go through the amended documents available on www.reps.gov.in and submit your offer accordingly. 2543/2026

Before Debts Recovery Tribunal-II, Delhi
4th Floor, Jeevan Tara Building, Parliament Street, New Delhi-110001.
Notice under section 19(4) of the Recovery of Debts Due to Bank and Financial Institutions Act, 1993 read with Rule 12 & 13 of the Debts Recovery Tribunal (Procedure Rule) 1993) in the matter of
OA No. 435/2024 DATE: 17.07.2026
STATE BANK OF INDIA .APPLICANT
VERSUS
SH VIKAS GANDHI .RESPONDENT
To,
DEFENDANT
D1. SH VIKAS GANDHI S/O SH HARI KISHAN GANDHI, PROP OF M/S ARADHAK IMPEX, 2H 14 NIT FACTORY AREA/FARIDABAD HRY
ALSO AT FLAT NO 27/44-45 NEAR HARDWARE CHOWK LAXMI RATTAN COMPLEX/FARIDABAD HRY 121001
Whereas the above named applicant(s) has/have instituted a case for recovery of Rs. 26,57,188/- (RUPEE TWENTY SIX LAKH FIFTY SEVEN THOUSAND ONE HUNDRED EIGHTY EIGHT ONLY) against you and whereas it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Tribunal that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way therefore, this notice is given by advertisement directing you to make appearance in the Tribunal on 17.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M.
Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day before the mentioned, the case will be heard and determined in your absence.
All the matters will be taken up through Video Conferencing or Physical and for that purpose:-
(i) All the Advocates/Litigants shall download the "Cisco Webex" application /software;
(ii) "Meeting ID" and "Password" for the date of hearing qua cases to be taken by Hon'ble Presiding officer/Registrar shall be displayed in the daily cause list itself at DRT Official Portal i.e. drt.gov.in.
(iii) In any exigency qua that the Advocate/Litigants can contact the concerned official at Ph.No. 23748478.
Given under my hand and seal of the Tribunal this 17th day of July, 2026.
BY ORDER OF THE TRIBUNAL
SECTION OFFICER, DRT-II, DELHI

millenniumpost
CLASSIFIEDS
CHANGE OF NAME
I, Sangeeta Kumari, W/o Sh. Sanjoy Kumar, aged about 55 years, Resident of 285-C, Paschim Vihar Extension New Delhi-110063, do hereby declare That in my Passport, the name of my husband has been mentioned as Sanjoy only due to inadvertence/ clerical omission. That the correct and complete name of my husband is Sanjoy Kumar
I, Sanjay Kumar, S/o Late Sh. Ved Prakash aged about 54 years, Resident of 285-C, Paschim Vihar Extension, New 110063 do hereby declare That due to an inadvertent/clerical error, my wife's surname has been mentioned as Vaish in my Passport instead of her correct name Sangeeta Kumari That my wife's correct name is Sangeeta Kumari.

ICC drops case against Darfur militia leader Abdallah Banda

THE HAGUE: International Criminal Court judges reluctantly dropped a case on Thursday against a fugitive Sudanese rebel accused of attacking African Union peacekeepers in Darfur nearly 20 years ago, after prosecutors said they could no longer prove their case at trial.

Judges were unusually critical of prosecutors at the global court. AGENCIES

RUBIO HOLDS TALKS WITH RUSSIAN COUNTERPART ‘US ready to help end senseless war in Ukraine but no quick deal ahead’

MANILA: US Secretary of State Marco Rubio said Thursday that the Trump administration is poised to help end the “senseless war” in Ukraine but acknowledged there is no quick path to a deal, saying diplomacy will require sustained effort and new ideas.

Rubio, who held talks with his Russian counterpart Sergey Lavrov in the Philippine capital, alluded to how US-mediated talks have stalled. He called them “unsuccessful or at least unfruitful” in the past, but



US Secretary of State Marco Rubio (left), attends a meeting with Russia's Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov, (right), on the sidelines of ASEAN Foreign Ministers Meeting in Manila on Thursday AP/PTI

insisted that President Donald Trump was committed to the work “if conditions and factors have changed to make that possible.”

“That’s been the challenge — an end that both sides can accept,” Rubio told reporters. “We’ve tried, and we’ll continue to try to see if we can, you know, find a middle ground that brings this about. And we’re prepared to play that role if the opportunity presents itself.”

Rubio met Lavrov and several other leaders, including China’s foreign minister,

on the sidelines of an annual gathering by foreign ministers of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations in Manila.

America’s top diplomat said the US is focused on Asia even as it steps up fighting with Iran, seeks a pathway to end Russia’s war in Ukraine and pressures the Cuban government to make changes.

Three days of closed-door talks that started Tuesday have centred on the escalating fighting in the Middle East and tensions in the South China Sea, where a new clash flared Thursday. AGENCIES

MADHYA PRADESH POWER GENERATING COMPANY LTD.
OFFICE OF THE Addl. C.E. (P&W), SHREE SINGAJI THERMAL POWER PROJECT, Dongalia Distt. Khandwa (MP) E-mail id: sepnw.sstpp1@gmail.com, Web.: www.mppgcl.mp.gov.in
No. 515-1700/SSTPP/MPPGCL/P&W/3363 Dated : 23.07.2026

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

Tender Particulars/Tender Number	Estimated Cost (Rs.) (including GST)	Tender Cost & EMD in Rs.	Last Date and Time for Closing of Online Submission
Work Contract of day to day routine maintenance of 220kv and 400 kv Switchyard , all HT and LT transformers, Overhead line faults, lighting of BOP and BTG building in plant , street lighting in plant, to raw water intake and inside colony and maintenance of electrical installation siwariya township as per scope of work of Phase-I, SSTPP,MPPGCL, Dongalia. (T-2026_MPPGC_514545_1)	Rs. 1,06,95,483/- (Including G.S.T.)	2,00,000/- & 5000/-	19.08.2026 Up to 15:30 hrs.
Work Contract for routine/preventive/ breakdown maintenance of control and instrumentation equipment and its associated system including annual overhauling (AOH) work of same of SSTPP, Stage-II i.e. 2X660MW, Unit 3 and 4, Dongalia.(T-2026_MPPGC_514576_1)	Rs. 5,57,87,803/- (Including G.S.T.)	5,57,900/- & 5000/-	24.08.2026 Up to 15:30 hrs.
Supply and Application/Dosing for Enhancement in Coal Flowability of wet coal for O/o S.G.E. (Services)-II, SSTPP, MPPGCL, Dongalia. (T-2026_MPPGC_523627_1)	Rs. 88,50,000/- (Including G.S.T.)	1,77,000/- & 2000/-	30.07.2026 Up to 15:30 hrs.

For extension & other details, the bidders are requested to please visit e-portal of GoMP at www.mptenders.gov.in
M.P. Madhyam/127144/2026 // SAVE ELECTRICITY // SE (P&W)

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, PUBLIC WORKS DIVISION, ASHTI
E-TENDER NOTICE ASHTI/ 04 OF 2026-27
E-Tenders for (05) Works in B-I form is invited by the Executive Engineer, Public Works Division Ashti from the registered Contractors in appropriate class of Public Works Department of Govt. of Maharashtra for the roads/repair of roads/repair of buildings/construction of new buildings in Tal. Ashti/Patoda/Shirur Dist. Beed. Right is reserved to reject any or all tenders without any reason thereof.
The details can be viewed and downloaded from following website.
www.mahapwd.com
<https://maharashtra.etenders.in>
Sd/-
Executive Engineer
Public Works Division, Ashti
DGIPR/2026/27/1888

Office of the Resident Commissioner Govt. of Jharkhand New Jharkhand Bhawan Bangla Sahib Road, New Delhi-110001.

Notice Inviting Short-Term (re) e-tender
The tender invited through PR.NO. 384104 Cabinet (26-27) : D is hereby cancelled due to administrative reason and re-tender is invited for the same. e-tenders are invited from reputed interested bidders for providing premises for the accommodation to Security Personnel of Jharkhand Bhawan, New Delhi.
1. Date of issue of Tender notice in website - 25.07.2026 10:00 AM
2. Bid Submission start date & time - 25.07.2026 11:00 AM
3. Bid Submission end date & time - 31.07.2026 06:00 PM
4. Date & Time of opening of technical bid - 03.08.2026 11:00 AM
5. Date & Time of opening of financial bid - To be notified when evaluation of technical bid is completed.
Details & tender document can be downloaded from website-jharkhandtenders.gov.in. Non-commercial entities can register themselves by entering GST No./PAN No. etc. in the place of registration number at registration portal at jharkhandtenders.gov.in, in case registration number is not available.
Sd/-
Chief Administrative Officer
PR 385629 Cabinet(26-27)D

झारखण्ड सरकार
अधीनस्थ का कार्यालय,
शहीद निर्मल महतो मेडिकल कॉलेज अस्पताल, धनबाद
दूरभाष : 0326-2230352(O), 9431120164(M) Email: superintendentsnmnmch@gmail.com
पत्रांक :- 1305 / SNMMCH दिनांक :- 23.07.2026
ई-निविदा सूचना
शहीद निर्मल महतो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय अस्पताल, धनबाद में वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27 के लिए मानक स्तर के निर्माताओं अथवा उनके अधिकृत एवं अनुमोदी वितरक से नेत्र रोग विभाग के उपयोग हेतु High End Phaco Machine with Inbuilt Compressor and Cassette Based Resuable Tubing system के क्रय आपूर्ति एवं अधिस्वापन हेतु 2-बोली व्यवस्था (2-bid system) के ONLINE निविदा आमंत्रित किया जाता है। जिसका Gem Bid No.- Gem/2026/B/7783302 है। ई-निविदा को www.Gem.gov.in पर देखी तथा इच्छुक संवेदक द्वारा भाग ली जा सकती है। निविदा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि- 12.08.2026 को संंध्या 05.00 बजे तक होगी।
हो / -
अधीनस्थ
शहीद निर्मल महतो मेडिकल कॉलेज अस्पताल धनबाद
PR 385667 Health Med Edu and Family Welfare(26-27)#D

MADHYA PRADESH POWER GENERATING COMPANY LTD.
OFFICE OF THE Addl. C.E. (P&W), SHREE SINGAJI THERMAL POWER PROJECT, Dongalia Distt. Khandwa (MP) E-mail id: sepnw.sstpp1@gmail.com, Web.: www.mppgcl.mp.gov.in
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M.P. Madhyam/127144/2026 // SAVE ELECTRICITY // SE (P&W)

NORTHERN RAILWAY
e-OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

Name of work with location, cost of work and Earnest money	1. Construction of 20 km boundary wall at vulnerable locations in station yards on an NRWAKDE under ADEN/KUN.	2. Rs. 999980.30/-	3. Rs. 24970380.86/-
2. Replacement of TWS. Glued joints, SEJ, ERC Greasing, cess cleaning, jungle cleaning, shallow screening in the section of ADEN/PNP.	1. Rs. 4069400/-	2. Rs. 2000000/-	3. Rs. 150000/-
3. Repair to leaky roofs of Relay rooms and battery rooms and worn out roof treatment, damaged sun shades, inside and outside plaster, rain water pipes etc to avoid roof leakage of station buildings and miscellaneous repair works of service buildings & staff quarters, gang quarters of AMIN, NLKR, TRR, BZK, BZJT, GRA, & KUN on DUK section under ADEN/KUN.	1. Rs. 4069400/-	2. Rs. 2000000/-	3. Rs. 150000/-
4. 1). Replacement of deteriorated platform coping & repairs to PF shelters, PF surface at SMK PF 1 and 2, BDMJ, PNP, PF4.5, DWNA and improvement to PF surface, improvements to circulating area at SMK and PNP in the section of SSE(W) PNP under ADEN/PNP. 2) Augmentation in the water supply facilities by providing 3 No's new deep bore well to meet water requirements at PNP and one bore well at BBDE, mechanized cleaning of OH and UC tanks, chlorination and Rainwater harvesting works, provision of pump houses at various locations in the section of SSE(W)/PNP under ADEN/PNP. 3) Repair of doors, windows and provision of mosquito proof wire gauge doors in staff qtrs. and major repair of flooring, plastering, roof leakage, drainage and sanitary arrangement of staff qtrs SSE(W)/PNP under ADEN/PNP.	1. Rs. 203467524.76/-	2. Rs. 999980.30/-	3. Rs. 24970380.86/-
Approx. Cost:	1. Rs. 203467524.76/-	2. Rs. 999980.30/-	3. Rs. 24970380.86/-
Earnest Money	1. Rs. 4069400/-	2. Rs. 2000000/-	3. Rs. 150000/-
Completion Period	12 Months for working at S.No. 1, 2, 3, 4		
Date and time of submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 15:00 hrs on 14.08.2026 opening of e-tender after 15:00 hrs on 14.08.2026.		
Website particulars, published-tender, notice location etc complete details of tender can be seen and website where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in		
Similar nature of work	S.No 1.Precast RCC/PSC work. S.No 2.Any type of track work. S.No 3 & 4. Any civil work other than track work.		
No. -	128-W/280/Tender Notice/26-27/W-4 (NIT-20, 21, 22, 23) Dated: 22.07.2026		2540/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Govt says it bore ₹700+ LPG subsidy per cylinder in June

‘Even for month of July 2026, implicit subsidy on each 14.2 Kg domestic LPG cylinder is over ₹500/cylinder’

NEW DELHI: The government on Thursday said domestic LPG cylinders carried an implicit subsidy of more than Rs 700 per 14.2 kg cylinder in June this year despite a sharp rise in international LPG prices triggered by the West Asia crisis, helping keep retail prices affordable for consumers.

In a written reply to a question in the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for Petroleum and Natural Gas Suresh Gopi said, “The Retail Selling Price of domestic LPG is being maintained at Rs. 942 per 14.2 Kg cylinder, carrying an implicit subsidy (under-recovery) of more than Rs 700 per 14.2 Kg cylinder, in June 2026. Even for the month of July 2026, the implicit subsidy on each 14.2 Kg domestic LPG cylinder is more than Rs 500 per cylinder.”

The ministry said global LPG prices surged after the outbreak of the West Asia conflict, with the average Saudi Contract Price (Saudi CP), the international benchmark for LPG pricing, rising to \$780 per metric tonne (MT) in April and May 2026 and further to \$796 per metric tonne in June.

It said that at these international prices, the market-determined price of a 14.2



kg domestic LPG cylinder would have reached Rs 1,695 in June.

“For more than 10.5 crore PMUY consumers, the effective price is only Rs. 642 per cylinder (Delhi), after a targeted subsidy of Rs. 300 per cylinder, in addition to the implicit subsidy of more than Rs 500 per cylinder,” the minister said.

The government also highlighted the steps taken to maintain uninterrupted LPG supplies despite disruptions caused by the closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

According to the reply,

India earlier imported around 60 per cent of its LPG requirement, with nearly 90 per cent of those imports transiting through the Strait of Hormuz.

The government said it responded by increasing domestic LPG production from 34 TMT per day to 54 TMT per day, diversifying import sources, prioritising household consumption, dynamically managing stocks and reallocating supplies across regions.

“Despite this unprecedented crisis, supply of LPG to all households in the country has been ensured without any

Highlights

» ‘Global LPG prices surged after outbreak of the West Asia conflict, with the average Saudi Contract Price rising to \$780/MT in April and May 2026 and further to \$796/MT in June

» At these international prices, market-price of a 14.2 kg domestic LPG cylinder would have reached Rs 1,695 in June, the govt said

disruption. During the peak of this crisis, more than 56 crore domestic LPG cylinders were delivered between March and June 2026, including more than 12 crore cylinders to Ujjwala families,” the reply said.

The government further said it paid Rs 22,000 crore to oil marketing companies (OMCs) in FY2022-23 and is paying Rs 30,000 crore during FY2025-26 and FY2026-27 to keep domestic LPG affordable. However, it added that “accumulated under-recovery of the PSU OMCs on domestic LPG was more than Rs 51,000 crores as of 30th June 2026 itself.” ANI

AMID FLUCTUATING CRUDE PRICES Govt remains non-committal on reducing petrol & diesel prices

NEW DELHI: The government on Thursday did not indicate whether it would reduce petrol and diesel prices despite the recent decline in Brent crude oil prices, saying international oil markets remain highly volatile due to the ongoing West Asia crisis and public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) have incurred heavy losses.

In a written reply to an unstarred question in the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for Petroleum and Natural Gas Suresh Gopi cited the continued volatility in international crude oil prices due to the West Asia crisis as the government responded to queries related to reduction in petrol and diesel prices.

“The price of Brent crude oil was \$122.86/barrel on 30th April 2026 and \$68.17/barrel on 2nd July 2026. However, the Brent crude prices continue to heavily fluctuate and have again increased to \$92.19/barrel on 21st July 2026,” the minister said.

The reply came in response to a question on whether the government had taken any decision to reduce the prices of petrol and petroleum products, including LPG, in line with the decline in Brent crude oil prices.

While explaining the factors influencing domestic fuel prices, the government did not comment on decision on reducing the retail prices of petrol or diesel.

Instead, the government



‘To protect consumers from its impact, in March 2026, govt reduced excise duties on petrol & diesel by Rs 10 per litre each, resulting in a negative impact on its tax revenues’

said India imports more than 88 per cent of its crude oil requirement and that international crude prices have risen significantly since March 2026 because of the West Asia crisis.

“To protect consumers from its impact, in March 2026, government reduced the excise duties on petrol and diesel by Rs. 10 per litre each, resulting

in a substantial negative impact on its tax revenues,” the minister said.

The reply also said the continuing geopolitical uncertainty had affected the finances of state-run oil retailers.

“The conflict in the West Asia has not abated and the resultant geopolitical situation continues to be highly volatile. PSU OMCs have incurred huge losses on the sale of petrol, diesel, LPG, etc. Against this, Petrol and Diesel prices were increased only marginally by the PSU OMCs,” the minister said.

According to the government, the current retail selling price in Delhi stands at Rs 102.12 per litre for petrol and Rs 95.20 per litre for diesel.

The reply did not specify any timeline or conditions under which petrol and diesel prices could be reduced. ANI

Rupee falls 20 paise to 96.73 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee declined 20 paise to close at 96.73 against the US dollar on Thursday, as heightened hostilities in West Asia kept global crude oil prices elevated. However, a likely intervention by the RBI provided support to the local unit, forex traders said.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 96.53 and traded in a range of 96.45-96.73 during the day before settling at 96.73, down 20 paise from its previous close.

The rupee depreciated by 28 paise to close at 96.53 against the US dollar on Wednesday.

“The rupee traded with a negative bias on weak domestic markets and surge in crude oil prices, which continued to rise as the US struck Iran for the 12th consecutive day while Iran continued to strike US facilities in Gulf,” Anuj Choudhary, Research Analyst, Mirae Asset ShareKhan, said.

“However, diplomatic talks between the two nations may prevent sharp fall in the rupee. USD-INR spot price is expected to trade in a range of Rs 96.30 to Rs 96.85,” Choudhary said.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback’s strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading flat at 101.12. PTI

UltraTech Cement plans to raise ₹5K cr from market via NCD’s



NEW DELHI: UltraTech Cement on Thursday said it is planning to raise up to Rs 5,000 crore through issuance of non-convertible debentures (NCDs) on a private placement basis.

The Finance Committee of the board approved a proposal to raise funds by issuance of up to 5,00,000 non-convertible, non-cumulative debentures of Rs 1,00,000 each, it said in a BSE filing.

Further details regarding the tenure, coupon rate and timeline of the tranches are awaited.

Earlier this week, UltraTech Cement reported a jump of 17.23 per cent in June quarter consolidated net profit at Rs 2,603.72 crore and 15.85 per cent rise in revenue from operations at Rs 24,648.20 crore.

UltraTech leads the cement industry with a total grey cement capacity of 205.5 MTPA and white cement/putty capacity of 3.2 MTPA.

It is also planning to foray into the cables and wires business this fiscal. PTI

EU hits Google with \$1 billion fine over its Play app store and search

BRUSSELS: The European Union (EU) on Thursday hit Google with a fine of 890 million euros (\$1 billion) after it said the technology behemoth broke digital antitrust regulations by setting up Google Play and its ubiquitous search engine to corral consumers towards its own services and apps to the detriment of competitors.

It was the latest major crack-down on Big Tech by Brussels, which has led the world in reining in some of the world’s largest companies from Silicon Valley to Beijing.

Google had recently lost its appeal of a \$4.5 billion antitrust fine imposed for throttling competition and reducing consumer choice through the dominance of its mobile Android operating system.

The European Commission,



the bloc’s executive branch, said it was acting in the interest of consumers.

“The best products should succeed because they’re better, not because they’re owned by the company running the search engine. And European consumers have a right to be told by app developers where to sign up to the best offers, even when the app store owner does not get a cut,” said Teresa Ribera, the commission’s Executive Vice President for Clean, Just and

Competitive Transition. Google’s President of Global Affairs Kent Walker blasted the fine as “product degradation driven by a small group of self-serving complainants” that will negatively impact European businesses and consumers.

He said that the EU’s Digital Markets Act forces Google “to strip away real-time search features Europeans love — like instant pricing and direct availability for hotels, flights, and restaurants — and dismantle safety protections on Google Play.”

“In the EU, businesses have the right to compete fairly. Gatekeepers have the obligation to ensure a level playing field and consumers the right to choose for cheaper alternative offers,” European Commission spokesperson Thomas Regnier said. AGENCIES

‘Railway aims 40% freight modal share in 10 yrs’

NEW DELHI: Indian Railways aims to increase freight’s share in the country’s total freight movement from about 24 per cent currently to 30-40 per cent over the next five to ten years, a senior Railway Board official said on Thursday.

Addressing the seventh edition of FICCI’s Smart Railways Conclave, Future Rail India 2026, Rajesh Agarwal, Additional Member (Works), Railway Board, said freight demand on the rail network is projected to reach 8,000 billion tonnes by 2030.

He noted that Indian Railways has become the world’s second-largest freight carrier by volume, up from fourth, but its domestic freight share remains below potential.

Agarwal said 514 sanc-



Rajesh Agarwal, Additional Member (Works), Railway Board

tioned projects, including 169 new lines, 316 doubling works and 29 gauge conversions, cover around 40,000 km. Of these, only about 12,500 km have been commissioned, leaving nearly 27,000 km pending.

The Railways plans to complete 4,000-5,000 km annually and finish over 90 per cent of the sanctioned projects within

five years.

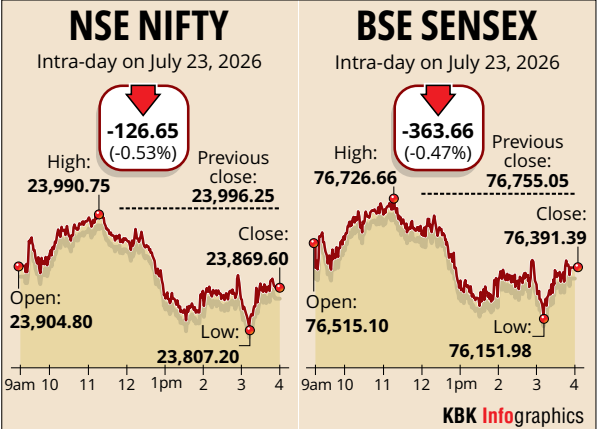
To accelerate execution, the Railway Board is introducing reforms such as initiating land acquisition and forest clearances before project sanction, deploying an AI-based drawing approval system developed with RailTel, centralising procurement, awarding five-year Project General Management Services contracts, and issuing a Project Information Memorandum to give industry advance visibility of tenders.

Agarwal also urged manufacturers and MSMEs to develop specialised rail construction equipment, standardised precast components and equipment-sharing platforms with trained operators to support large-scale mechanised track laying. ANI

MUMBAI: Stock markets closed with losses for the fourth straight day on Thursday, with the benchmark Sensex falling by 363 points as a sharp jump in crude oil prices due to escalating tensions in West Asia hit investor sentiment.

The 30-share BSE Sensex declined 363.66 points, or 0.47 per cent, to settle at a month’s low of 76,391.39, dragged by losses in blue-chip shares such as Reliance Industries, HDFC Bank, Bharti Airtel and Bajaj Finance. During the day, the index dropped 603.07 points, or 0.78 per cent, to a low of 76,151.98.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dipped 126.65 points, or 0.53 per cent, to end at a three-week low of 23,869.60, with realty, energy, and banking emerging as the biggest drags.



From the Sensex pack, Adani Ports was the biggest loser, dropping by 2.26 per cent. Bajaj Finance, InterGlobe Aviation, Axis Bank, State Bank of India and Tata Steel were among the major laggards.

Mahindra & Mahindra, Tata Consultancy Services, Eternal and Bajaj Finserv were among the winners from the pack.

FIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 819.20 crore on Wednesday after a day’s breather, according

to exchange data.

Broader markets logged sharper losses, with the BSE SmallCap Select index tanking 1.10 per cent and MidCap Select index by 1.07 per cent.

Among sectors, Realty tanked the most by 1.78 per cent, followed by Services (1.63 per cent), Telecom (1.34 per cent), Power (1.25 per cent), Utilities (1.12 per cent), Commodities (1.07 per cent), Bankex (0.97 per cent) and PSU Bank (0.97 per cent). Auto and Insurance were the gainers.

Market breadth was negative as a total of 2,684 stocks declined, while 1,556 advanced and 151 remained unchanged on the BSE. In four trading days, the BSE benchmark has tanked 1,760.06 points, or 2.25 per cent, and the Nifty declined 464.7 points, or 1.90 per cent. PTI

Bharat Ki Soch hosts 6th edition of series Shastra Se Samvad Tak

NEW DELHI: Think tank Bharat Ki Soch hosted the sixth edition of its flagship book discussion series, Shastra Se Samvad Tak, featuring former IMF economist and author Sri-ram Balasubramanian, who presented ideas from his latest book, Dharmaconomics: An Indigenous and Sustainable Economic Model.

Anil Rajput, Chairman, Bharat Ki Soch, said global debates are increasingly questioning growth models driven solely by GDP and shareholder returns. He stressed that as India aims to become a developed nation by 2047, economic growth must be balanced with sustainability, ethics, environ-

mental protection and social harmony. He added that India’s intellectual traditions should inform contemporary policy debates and practical solutions.

Balasubramanian explained how the concept of Dharma shaped economic policy across more than 2,500 years of Indian history, from the Saraswati Valley Civilization to the Chola, Pallava, Pandya and Vijayanagara dynasties. He highlighted the role of temples as economic hubs and Shrenis (guilds) in promoting trade, craftsmanship and financial services. He also linked Dharmaconomics with his earlier work, Kautilyanomics, describing the two books as complementary frameworks covering governance, ethics and sustainable development.

Meenakshi Lekhi, former Minister of State for External Affairs, compared India’s indigenous economic traditions with development models in South-east Asia and said economic and governance indicators should be viewed alongside a nation’s civilisational and cultural context.

The session concluded with remarks by R K Pachnanda, Director, Bharat Ki Soch, who said the discussion demonstrated how temples and Shrenis served as institutions supporting ethical and sustainable economic systems. MPOST

Outward Remittances under LRS reaches \$2,396 mn in May, up by 3.6% YoY, says RBI

May 2026 figure shows recovery of 4.8% from \$2,286.59 mn in April 2026

NEW DELHI: Outward remittances under the Liberalised Remittance Scheme (LRS) for resident individuals grew 3.6 per cent year-on-year (YoY) to \$2,396.42 million in May 2026.

The total forex outflow under the scheme climbed from \$2,313.16 million in May 2025, according to data published in the RBI Bulletin.

The data revealed that the cumulative outward remittances under LRS for the full FY26 reached \$28,979.36 million. On month-on-month,

the May 2026 figure reflected a recovery of 4.8 per cent from \$2,286.59 million recorded in April 2026, though it remained lower than the \$2,594.87 million remitted in March 2026. Travel remained the largest single category of foreign remittances during the month, accounting for \$1,282.63 million in May 2026 against \$1,389.23 million in May 2025, down by 7.6 per cent.

Within travel-related expenditure, other travel, which included holiday trips and payments for settling interna-

tional credit cards transactions, formed the largest segment at \$831.44 million. Travel for education stood at \$422.97 million, business travel recorded \$13.95 million, travel for pilgrimage accounted for \$10.13 million, and travel for medical treatment totaled \$4.13 million.

Outflows toward overseas investments and bank deposits showed notable growth during the period. Investment in equity and debt rose significantly to \$363.64 million in May 2026 from \$104.94 million in May

2025. Foreign bank deposits expanded to \$118.12 million from \$54.65 million over the same period.

Remittances for the maintenance of close relatives dropped to \$289.11 million from \$322.54 million, while gifts declined to \$201.50 million from \$233.30 million. Remittances for the purchase of immovable property stood at \$35.76 million, studies abroad at \$92.61 million, medical treatment at \$4.92 million, and donations at \$0.69 million. ANI

IndiGo flies into ₹238 crore net loss in Q1 FY27

NEW DELHI: IndiGo on Thursday reported a Rs 238 crore net loss for the three months ended June as higher fuel prices and the West Asia conflict resulted in turbulence for the country’s largest airline.

The airline had a profit of Rs 2,176.3 crore in the year-ago period.

In the first quarter of the current fiscal, InterGlobe Aviation saw its total income rise to Rs 25,614.1 crore from Rs 21,542.6 crore a year ago.

However, overall expenses surged during the same period, according to a release.

“A combination of fuel price escalation, adverse foreign exchange movement and the Middle East conflict impacted



profitability during the quarter, resulting in a net loss of Rs 2.4 billion,” it said.

The carrier’s net loss excluding foreign exchange amounted to Rs 56 million (Rs 5.6 crore) in the quarter under review, the release said.

InterGlobe Aviation is the parent of IndiGo, which has a domestic market share of over 66 per cent.

Providing a relatively muted

forecast for the September quarter, IndiGo said that capacity in terms of Available Seat Kilometres (ASKs) is expected to be broadly flat compared to the year-ago period, reflecting lower aircraft utilisation amid lower demand.

IndiGo Managing Director Rahul Bhatia said the first quarter was shaped by a volatile operating environment, with elevated fuel costs and network-related constraints in West Asia impacting profitability.

“At the same time, demand remained healthy, and our revenue performance improved year-on-year, supported by improved yields and continued customer preference for IndiGo, as we proudly served

more than 31 million passengers,” he pointed out.

Bhatia said the pressure of fuel costs and the rupee depreciation resulted in a loss of around Rs 2 billion for the first quarter.

In the June quarter, fuel cost jumped nearly 86 per cent to Rs 10,832.9 crore while the total expenses climbed 34 per cent to Rs 25,852.5 crore during the same period.

The airline’s yield increased to Rs 6.04 per kilometre in the latest June quarter from Rs 4.98 per kilometre recorded in the year-ago period.

RASK or Revenue per Available Seat Kilometre too rose to Rs 5.66 from Rs 4.86.

At the end of June, IndiGo had a fleet of 432 planes. PTI

‘India emerges as fastest-growing major economy on back of reforms’

‘Far-reaching measures in successive Budgets have provided strong foundations to unleash growth,’ ITC Chairman & MD Sanjiv Puri said

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India’s multidimensional policy interventions have enabled the country to emerge as the fastest-growing major economy in the world even as global volatility becomes “systemic” rather than sporadic, said ITC Chairman and Managing Director Sanjiv Puri.

Addressing shareholders at the company’s Annual General Meeting (AGM) on Thursday, Puri said the crisis in West Asia has had a severe impact on the global economy, and that recent global developments only reinforce the view that turbulence today is systemic rather than sporadic.

“The prolonged uncertainty arising from the West Asia crisis has severely impacted the global economy, threatening energy security and trade. Indeed, the multitude of events in the recent past only reinforce the fact that global volatility is no more sporadic; it is now systemic,” he said.

Against this backdrop, Puri said, the Prime Minister’s vision for an Aatmanirbhar Bharat and a Viksit Bharat has taken even greater significance, spurring multidimensional policy interventions that have helped India emerge as the fastest-growing



ITC Chairman and Managing Director Sanjiv Puri

major economy in the world.

“It has inspired multidimensional interventions enabling India to emerge as the fastest-growing major economy in the world,” he said.

“The far-reaching measures announced in successive Budgets have provided strong foundations to unleash growth. India’s ascent is not merely about outpacing other large economies,” Puri added.

It has demonstrated that a nation of continental scale, democratic depth and extraordinary diversity can drive momentum with stability, pursue reform with inclusion, and convert aspiration into resilient

growth.

Recalling his remarks from last year, when he had described the prevailing environment as an era of “TURN” — marked by Turbulence, Uncertainty and Rapid change — Puri said this reality has become even more pronounced as deeper structural shifts reshape the future of nations, societies and businesses.

He said the situation calls for novel strategies to help enterprises reimagine their approach to the future.

However, Puri also added that as India ascends on the global stage, Indian businesses must reimagine their strategies

HIGHLIGHTS

» ‘India’s ascent is not merely about outpacing other large economies,’ Puri added

» Recent developments only reinforce view that turbulence today is systemic rather than sporadic

» As India ascends on global stage, Indian bizs must reimagine their strategies

not only to navigate the TURN but also to seize the emerging opportunities.

In his speech, Puri highlighted that, despite the challenging operating environment, ITC had delivered positive results over the medium term.

Its “net Segment Revenue, currently at over Rs 83,300 crore, grew at a CAGR of 10.7 per cent over the last 5 years,” he said, adding now “Non-cigarette businesses constitute nearly two-thirds of net segment revenue.”

Moreover, over the last five years, ITC has distributed nearly Rs 85,000 crore to shareholders

by way of dividends.

“Foreign exchange earnings of the ITC Group over the last 5 years aggregated nearly US\$ 6.5 billion, of which agri exports constitute over 60 per cent,” demonstrating ITC’s contribution to the rural economy, he said.

Its FMCG business, which was around Rs 14,720 crore in FY21, now has crossed the Rs 24,200 crore mark in FY26, with sustained improvement in profitability.

“ITC has ranked consistently amongst the Top 3 Indian corporates in the private sector in terms of Contribution to the Exchequer. Over the last five years, over 76 per cent of its Value Added amounting to Rs 2,30,000 crore accrued to the exchequer,” he said.

Over the investments, Puri said it has already proposed a medium-term capex of Rs 20,000 crore for the Group in areas that have a multiplier impact. “Close on the heels of 8 recently commissioned facilities, 6 new projects are in the pipeline,” he said.

ITC’s Bharat Built Manufacturing architecture has created world-class national assets across FMCG, Paperboards & Packaging, and export-oriented value-added Agri Processing.

Govt allows FDI in inventory-based e-commerce model only for export

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government on Thursday permitted FDI in an inventory-based e-commerce model “exclusively” for export purposes, a move which will help increase India’s outbound shipments without impacting the businesses of small retailers.

These firms will have to export goods that are manufactured or produced in India. Also, FDI in inventory-based e-commerce retailing has not been permitted.

“In order to facilitate greater exports through easier and increased access of global markets by Indian sellers, the extant FDI Policy has been reviewed and it is decided that the restrictions on inventory-based model of e-commerce shall not apply in case of exports of domestically manufactured and/or produced goods/products,” the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) said in a Press Note.

This means that e-commerce firms with foreign stake can now maintain inventory only for export purposes. Earlier, the policy did not explicitly specify this.

DPIIT, an arm of the commerce and industry ministry, deals with foreign direct investment (FDI) related issues. It releases policy changes through Press Notes (PNs).

As per the current FDI policy, overseas investments are permitted in business-to-business e-commerce and marketplace models.

However, FDI is not allowed



As per estimates, the country’s e-commerce exports are about \$2 billion currently against China’s staggering \$350 billion

in business-to-consumer e-commerce and inventory-based e-commerce models where inventory of goods and services is owned by an online retailer and is sold to consumers directly.

DPIIT has inserted a clause in the policy, which states: “An e-commerce entity is permitted to engage in an inventory-based model of e-commerce exclusively for the export of goods/products manufactured and/or produced in India as per the applicable provisions of the Foreign Trade Policy 2023...and the Foreign Exchange Management (Export of Goods & Services) Regulations, 2015”.

It added that the restrictions on B2C and the inventory-based model of e-commerce will not apply to the export of goods/products through e-commerce.

The decision will come into

effect from the date of FEMA (Foreign Exchange Management Act) notification, it said.

The proposal was initially mooted by the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) to boost India’s exports through e-commerce. E-commerce stakeholders, too, have demanded the same.

The decision is important as the government is looking at ways to boost exports through the e-commerce medium.

It is working on other measures as well, such as setting up e-commerce export hubs.

As per estimates, the country’s e-commerce exports are about \$2 billion currently compared to China’s staggering \$350 billion. The global e-commerce trade is about \$800 billion and is estimated to reach \$2 trillion by 2030.

Commenting on the move, an industry official said that this is a positive step to facilitate exports through e-commerce and improve global market access for Indian manufacturers and sellers.

“The notification is specifically aimed at exports and should be viewed in that context. It does not alter the existing policy framework for domestic e-commerce, under which companies like Amazon, Flipkart, Meesho, etc operate,” the official said.

However, certain exporters have raised concerns that the decision may impact small exporters as they would now face competition from big e-commerce firms operating from India.

India enters FY27 with resilient exports, stronger FDI

NEW DELHI: India’s external sector entered FY27 with resilient merchandise exports and stronger foreign direct investment (FDI) inflows, although a rise in imports widened the merchandise trade deficit, according to the latest RBI Bulletin.

The bulletin showed that merchandise exports rose to \$45.14 billion in May 2026, up from \$43.72 billion in April,

led by both oil and non-oil shipments.

Non-oil exports increased to \$36.74 billion in May from \$33.98 billion a month earlier, indicating broad-based export activity.

Merchandise imports also increased during the month to \$73.40 billion, compared with \$71.93 billion in April, largely due to higher oil imports. As a result, the merchandise trade

deficit widened marginally to \$28.26 billion in May from \$28.21 billion in April.

On the investment front, net foreign direct investment stood at \$6.5 billion during April-May FY27, significantly higher than \$2.47 billion recorded in the corresponding period of the previous financial year.

Gross foreign direct investment inflows into India rose to

\$13.77 billion during the first two months of FY27, reflecting continued foreign investor interest.

However, the bulletin showed that portfolio investment remained in net outflow during April-May FY27, at \$12 billion, resulting in overall foreign investment outflows of \$5.5 billion during the period despite stronger FDI inflows. ANI

Infosys June quarter net profit up 12.2% at ₹7,769 cr

NEW DELHI: IT services company Infosys on Thursday reported a 12.2 per cent year-on-year rise in consolidated net profit to Rs 7,769 crore for the June quarter, and tempered the upper end of its full-year revenue forecast to between 1.5 per cent and 3 per cent amid continued macroeconomic uncertainty.

India’s second largest IT

services company saw revenue for Q1FY27 rise 14 per cent to Rs 48,211 crore.

Infosys also named company veteran Ashish Kumar Dash as CEO-designate, with the leadership transition scheduled for April 1, 2027, after incumbent Salil Parekh completes his second term, marking the end of a nine-year tenure. Notably for Infosys,

Parekh is its longest-serving CEO who is not one of the founders.

The company delivered \$5,082 million in Q1 revenues, year on year growth of 2.4 per cent and sequential growth of 1 per cent in constant currency (neutralising currency impact).

“We had a one-time revenue impact of a client decision during the quarter,” Infosys

CEO and MD Salil Parekh said.

AI services contributed 8.2 per cent of Infosys’ Q1 revenue, with the company highlighting strong momentum and long-term client relevance driven by AI-led services. Infosys said over 80,000 employees are using AI coding tools for client work and seeing strong traction across its six AI growth areas. PTI

Sport

Lovlina’s lucky break

High hopes as Borgohain’s bye gives India first medal guarantee

S KANNAN

GLASGOW: India were assured of their first medal at the 2026 Commonwealth Games even before the opening ceremony, with boxer Lovlina Borgohain receiving a bye into the women’s 75kg semi-finals.

With only five boxers in the category, Lovlina advanced directly to the last four without throwing a punch, guaranteeing India its first medal of the Games.

Hours before she led the Indian contingent as one of the flag-bearers alongside weightlifting star Mirabai Chanu, Lovlina attended a training session and appeared relaxed, posing for photographs before leaving the team hotel.

“I am happy. This is a good start and a good omen for us,” Indian Olympic Association president P.T. Usha said.

The semi-final berth also marks a welcome turnaround for Lovlina, who suffered a surprise quarter-final exit at the 2022 Birmingham Commonwealth Games. This time, she will begin her campaign with a medal already assured and will now target a place in the final.

“Lovlina is projected to win a big medal, hopefully gold. We will wait for it,” said India’s chef de mission Rohit Rajpal.



Lovlina Borgohain during a training session in Glasgow

PTI

Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya, meanwhile, urged athletes to compete without the burden of expectations.

“I expect good performances from our athletes, but I do not want to put pressure on them by talking about medals. Compete clean, fair and square,” he said.

Mandaviya credited the Khelo India programme for strengthening the country’s sporting ecosystem at the grassroots level. “Khelo India has been a boon for Indian

‘I am happy. This is a good start and a good omen for us’

sports,” he said.

The minister also joined members of the Indian diaspora in a cycling rally carrying the message ‘Cheer for Bharat’, reiterating his support for the Fit India movement.

“Cycling protects our health, our environment and

our planet,” he said.

Mandaviya also reiterated the government’s zero-tolerance approach to doping. His remarks came after judoka Arun Kumar reportedly tested positive in an out-of-competition test, while India also lost a weightlifting quota place because of a doping violation.

As India’s campaign gets underway in Glasgow, the hope is that the early medal boost provided by Lovlina will be matched by clean and successful performances.

Lawn bowls high for Sonowal

GLASGOW: Putul Sonowal stunned 2023 world champion Ryan Bester of Canada in tie-break in Lawn Bowls Men’s Singles as India began their Glasgow Commonwealth Games campaign on a confident note here on Thursday.

Rupa Rani Tirkey and Pinki Singh also won their Women’s Pairs opening match against Malta in tie-break as Lawn Bowls competition kicked off the Games.

Sonowal, who was making his Commonwealth Games debut, clinched the first set 5-4 before Bester, also a multiple Commonwealth Games medallist, came back with a dominating 7-3 win to take the contest to the tie-break. The Assam player, the reigning Asian champion, kept his cool to clinch the tie-break for a remarkable win in his opening match in Section D. AGENCIES

HARARE: Wonderkid Vaibhav Sooryavanshi smashed an 18-ball half century in his first innings of substance in international cricket as an all-round India outplayed Zimbabwe by seven wickets in the first T20 of the three match series here on Thursday.

Pacer Mayank Yadav made a successful return to international cricket as India restricted Zimbabwe to 125 for seven. India expectedly gunned down the target in 13.2 overs following a typical knock from Sooryavanshi (50 off 19) that included four boundaries and as many sixes.

It was also India’s first win under new captain Shreyas Iyer, who endured a run of six losses in his first assignment in Ireland and England.

Sooryavanshi’s much hyped international debut in England earlier this month did not go as per the script but made his familiarity with the venue count. In his return to the ground where he made a memorable 80-ball 175 in the U-19 World Cup final earlier this year, the youngest to play for India displayed his rare talent that has been acknowledged by the cricketing world.

While Abhishek Sharma (1 off 8) struggled at the other end, Sooryavanshi took down



Vaibhav Sooryavanshi celebrates his maiden T20 fifty

BCCI

15

At 15 years, Sooryavanshi is the youngest player to score a fifty in men’s international cricket

the Zimbabwe attack bit by bit.

He began with couple of breathtaking sixes off Richard Ngarava in the second over of the chase. The first one was a one legged pull shot that sailed

over deep square leg before he made a slight room to nonchalantly a dispatch a decent length ball over mid-off.

Blessing Muzarabani, who did not allow Sooryavanshi to free his arm initially, was also taken to the cleaners in fifth over when the 15-year-old smoked a 90m six down the ground. He brought his fifty right after powerplay and a ball later he was caught at third man off Ngarava.

Following his dismissal, Ishan Kishan (35 off 24) and captain Shreyas Iyer (28 not out off 24) got the job done comfortably. Earlier, Mayank Yadav cranked up serious pace from the get go in his first game for India since October 2024. AGENCIES

Sindhu bows out early from China Open, Sen, Shetty follow suit

CHANGZHOU: PV Sindhu squandered an early advantage to bow out of the China Open with a gruelling three-game loss to local favourite and world No. 4 Chen Yufei in the second round here on Thursday.

Ayush Shetty and Lakshya Sen, too, exited the tournament after losing their

respective men’s singles second-round matches. Lakshya lost in straight games to Canada’s Victor Lai 19-21, 11-21 while Ayush suffered a narrow three-game defeat to Ireland’s Nhat Nguyen (21-15, 13-21, 20-22) after letting slip a 19-15 advantage in the decider.

Sindhu lost 21-16, 20-22, 18-21 in an energy-sapping

contest that lasted nearly one and a half hours. The 30-year-old from Hyderabad had entered on a high after winning the Japan Open last week.

After her match, Sindhu vented her frustration over getting inadequate time to recover between matches, taking to social media to criticise the scheduling. AGENCIES

NEW DELHI: Dutch coach Sjoerd Marijne is aiming for the stars with the Indian women’s hockey team, with his biggest goal being to secure a podium finish at the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics -- a feat he narrowly missed at the Tokyo Games.

The Dutchman, who

coached India from 2017 to 2021, is now looking to go one step further after returning to the role earlier this year.

To achieve that goal, he has enlisted the help of an inspirational speaker to motivate his players, and the move has already yielded encouraging results, with India winning the FIH Nations Cup this year to earn promotion back to the elite FIH Pro League for next season. “...There is an inspira-



tional speaker, who talks about scaling bigger mountains like

Kilimanjaro. Our bigger goal is to get a medal at the 2028 Olympics, and for that we have to work towards getting to our first base camp. Our first base camp was the FIH Nations Cup and qualifying for the World Cup. If you need to reach the top every time you need to reach the base camp first. We are climbing that mountain together and we are reaching for the stars and if you reach for the stars you will fall on

the highest mountain,” Marijne said.

“The real star for me is to finish on the podium in 2028. That is a process, that is about small steps you are taking, it’s about recovery, bringing a good staff together, bringing the right players, mixing talent, mixing seniority with juniors. Everything is about building a culture and every person in that culture needs to be the best version of themselves.” AGENCIES

● NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
E-TENDERING NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Electrical/ General), North Eastern Railway, Varanasi for and on behalf of President of India, invites Online (E-Tendering) "Open Tenders" for the following work. **S.N. 1. Tender Reference No:** E-Tender-L-22-26-27; **Name of work:** Electrical work connection to- (1) Siwan- Yard remodeling with essential additional traffic facilities work (3 running lines, conversion of no running line into running line, Dockab PF etc.), (2) augmentation of S & T assets by provision by electronic interlocking at HTW station in connection with BPCL siding., (3)AtTHE-Phase-II-Provision of one stabling line(700m) and one running line (750m) (AC in SS/ASM office at the station of THE-SV & SV-BTT sec.); **Approx. Cost (in ₹):** ₹68,13,574.14; **Earnest money (in ₹):** ₹1,36,300/-; **Completion Period:** 04 Months; **Date & time of Closing Tender:** 13.08.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; **Date & time of Opening Tender:** 13.08.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; **S.N. 2. Tender Reference No:** E-Tender-L-23-26-27; **Name of work:** Electrical work connection to (1 Electrical work connection to- (1) Construction of S&T Goomti under work Provision of second goods shed common running line of CSL-730m at Pharia. (2) Provision of modular Sewage Treatment Plant at NGT nominated stations Belthara Road & Kharasan Road stations. (3) Additional work of BLTR station under ABSS. (4) Additional work of SRU station under ABSS. (5) Provision of Type-II (6 unit) Type-III (1 unit) & Type-IV (1 unit) Quarter for Track machine staff at D.L.R. (6) MAU Jn- Extension of FOB (6.0 m wide); **Approx. Cost (in ₹):** ₹63,76,448.11; **Earnest money (in ₹):** ₹1,27,500/-; **Completion Period:** 06 Months; **Date & time of Closing Tender:** 13.08.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; **Date & time of Opening Tender:** 13.08.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; **S.N. 3. Tender Reference No:** E-Tender-L-24-26-27; **Name of work:** Electrical work connection to- (1) Additional work of DEOS station under ABSS. (2) Additional work of BTT station under ABSS. (3) Provision of Foot over Bridge (6.0m wide) at CPJ. (4) Provision of store room at LIJ and JGP. KKT & SSU, New waiting hall at TRJ and miscellaneous work at KKT. (5) Provision of Interlocking LC gates irrespective of TVU on account of Restricted visibility in BSB Division with RTU & Power Supply arrangement. (Total 08 No. LC). (6) Provision of Interlocking of LC gates having more than 50000 TVU in BSB Division with RTU & Power Supply arrangement (SQW-RTU-35 Spl & POU-KKT-64 Spl) (Total 02 No. LC); **Approx. Cost (in ₹):** ₹22,44,200/-; **Earnest money (in ₹):** ₹2,44,200/-; **Completion Period:** 06 Months; **Date & time of Closing Tender:** 14.08.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; **Date & time of Opening Tender:** 14.08.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; For full details of above E-Tender work and to participate in tenders please visit Indian Railway website www.ireps.gov.in

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ CPRO/EL-100 General, Varanasi

DO NOT SMOKE BID/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, हजारीबाग
E-mail: rdshazariabagh@gmail.com

शुद्धि पत्र
इस कार्यालय के द्वारा आमंत्रित अल्पकालीन ई० निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या RDSPL/SD/HZB/16/2026-27 पीआर० संख्या 385239 Rural Development(26-27).D के online प्रकाशित निविदा के ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – 9934523795 पढ़ा जाय।
निविदा की शेष शर्तें यथावत् रहेंगी।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल
हजारीबाग
PR 385702 Rural Development(26-27)#D

OFFICE OF THE RANCHI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, RANCHI (SANITATION SECTION)
KUTCHERY ROAD, RANCHI, PIN-834001
E-Mail: -support@ranchimunicipal.com

Short Notice Inviting E Tender		
NIT No. 892/Sanitation		Date: 23/07/2026
Sl. No.	Event	Details
1.	Name of Work	Request for Proposal for Procurement of Push Cart Fitted with Bins for Manual Sweeping.
2.	Publishing of Tender	For more details and bid documents please visit website: www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
3.	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Rs 4000/- (Rupees Four Thousand Only) shall be paid towards earnest money deposit through online payment gateway of www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
4.	Tender Fee	Rs 5000/- + 18% GST (i.e. Rs 5900) (non-refundable) (excluding indirect taxes, services & gateway charges) shall be paid through online payment gateway of www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
5.	Bid Validity	90 Days
6.	Bid Start Date	24/07/2026
7.	Bid Due Date	07/08/2026 at 5:00 PM
8.	Date & Time of Bid Opening	08/08/2026 at 3:00 PM
9.	Place of Tender Opening	Ranchi Municipal Corporation
10.	Officer Inviting	Additional Municipal Commissioner, Ranchi Municipal Corporation
11.	contact Details	0651 – 2203469

Eligibility Criteria & Project Details:- Interested bidders are advised to go through the NIT and RFP document for information pertaining to Eligibility Criteria and Project related information. Interested Bidder shall submit the Proposal electronically through the website www.jharkhandtender.gov.in other important/relevant documents, should be scanned and enclosed with the e-tender as per the guidelines given in the RFP document.

- Note:**
- RMC reserves the right to cancel or modify the bidding criteria/ process without assigning any reasons and liability.
 - For further detail can be seen on Bid Document uploaded on Jharkhandtender.gov.in.

Sd/-
Add. Municipal Commissioner
Ranchi Municipal Corporation
PR.NO.385683 Ranchi Municipal Corporation(26-27):D

UJVNL LTD.

H.O.: 'UJJWAL', Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135 - 2763808, Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101HR2001SGC025868, Website: www.ujvn.com

Letter No 610

Tender Notice
Dated 23.07.2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Maintenance), Vyasi Project, Hathiyari, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
NIT No. 11/EE(M)/VP/2026-27
Name of work:- Refilling and repairing of different type of fire extinguisher at Vyasi HEP, Hathiyari
Estimated cost: Rs. 7.43,325.00 (Excluding GST)
Date of availability of bid document on website : 24-07-2026 From 16:00 PM
Last date for submission of tender : 14-08-2026 Up-to 13:30 PM
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website www.ujvn.com
Executive Engineer (Maintenance)

"Avoid Wasteful use of Electricity"

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Nagrota, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Mans Sahu S/O Bajman R/O Odissa is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 99/2018 U/S 454/38 IPC of P/S Nagrota, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.
It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name : Mans Sahu

S/O : Bajman

Address : Odissa

Age : 30 years'

Height : 5' 6"

Complexion : Wheatish

Eyes : Black

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578

2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

3.PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949

4.SP Rural Jammu : 0191-2605949

5.SDPO Nagrotar : 0191-2673666

6.SHO P/S Nagrota : 0191-2673025

Sd/-
For Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-6421/26

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE
(Through e-tendering)

Name of work with its location

Comprehensive Annual maintenance Contract of HASSDAC of G.G.TRONICS make for three years over Delhi Division.

App. Cost of the work (₹)

Rs. 3,92,76,743.76/-

Bid Security (₹)

Rs. 7,85,500.00/-

Address of the office

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3rd Floor, Annexe-1, DRM Office, New Delhi-110055.

Date & Time for uploading the tender/closing of tender

Tender uploading **22.07.2026** closing date & time - **13.08.2026** up to 15.00 hrs.

Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc.

See the Northern Railway website www.ireps.gov.in & Notice board at S&T branch, 3rd Floor, DRM Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055.

Tender No. 558-Sig-16-M-T-AMC-099

Dated: 22.07.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

2516/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2) (ii) Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused persons namely **Karan @ Rahul S/o Kale R/o Jhuggi No.16/49, Ghadee Wali, Zakhira, Delhi**, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 04/2023 U/s 392/397/411/34 IPC**, has been registered at **PS: Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Karan @ Rahul** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Karan @ Rahul** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Karan @ Rahul** of under **FIR No. 04/2023 U/s 392/397/411/34 IPC**, Registered at: **PS: Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.09.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Abhishek Goyal

Ld. ASJ-03 (Central), Room No. 143

Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10129/N/2026

(Court Notice)

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Nagrota, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Gul Mohd S/O Noor Hussain R/O Upper Ragoora Sidhra is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 264/2015 U/S 279/188/427 RPC, 3/5 PCA Act, 179/184 MV Act of P/S Nagrota, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded. Moreover, the Hon'ble Court has also issued General Warrant of arrest U/S 512/299 Cr.PC in respect of said accused person.
It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name : Gul Mohd

S/O : Noor Hussain

Address : Upper Ragoora Sidhra

Age : 38 years'

Height : 5' 6"

Complexion : Wheatish

Eyes : Brown

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578

2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

3.PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949

4.SP Rural Jammu : 0191-2605949

5.SDPO Nagrotar : 0191-2673666

6.SHO P/S Nagrota : 0191-2673025

Sd/-
For Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-6442/26

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Sohan Lal Malik
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Bhiwani
VED PARKASH
VS.
BHAGWATI DEVI
CNR No. HRBH02-000111-2022
Next Date 10-08-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
2.(1) MANOJ SINGH S/O PREM SINGH
2(2) PRADEEP SINGH S/O LATE PREM SINGH
2(3) ANKITA D/O LATE PREM SINGH S/O PRATAP SINGH
3. LAL SINGH S/O PRATAP SINGH
4. (1) SAKSHI D/O LATE MAHABIR SINGH S/O PRATAP SINGH
4(3) ROKSHI D/O LATE MAHABIR SINGH
4(4)DEEPTI D/O LATE MAHABIR SINGH S/O PRATAP SINGH
5. MAYABAI D/O PRATAP SINGH
6. DAYABAI D/O PRATAP SINGH
7. KAILASHBAI D/O PRATAP SINGH
ALL R/O GANGU SINGH KI GALLI, JAIN CHOWK, BHIWANI
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **10-08-2026 at 10:00 am**. For details login to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=districtnotice&district=Bhiwani>
Sd/- Sh. Sohan Lal Malik
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division)
Bhiwani
Dated 15-07-2026

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Sukhbir
Civil Judge (Junior Division) Bhiwani
KAMLESH
VS.
MC BAWANI KHERA AND ANR.
CS -446-2026
CNR No. . HRBH02-000764-2026
Next Date 28-08-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
SUSHIL KUMAR SARDANA SON OF HARICHAND SARDANA,
R/O POKKET 01, SECTOR 29 NORTH WEST ROHINI, DELHI
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **28-08-2026 at 10:00 am**. For details login to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=districtnotice&district=Bhiwani>
Sd/- Sh. Sukhbir
Civil Judge (Junior Division)
Bhiwani
Dated 23.07.2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C.)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Udhay Bhan Singh @ Monu R/o H. No. L-2/6, Shastri Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 500/2021, U/s 323/325/354/506/509/342/34 IPC, PS Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Udhay Bhan Singh @ Monu** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Udhay Bhan Singh @ Monu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Udhay Bhan Singh @ Monu** of case **FIR No. 500/2021, U/s 323/325/354/354B/506/509/342/34 IPC, PS Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **24.08.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Manya

Judicial Magistrate First Class

Mahila Court-02, Room No. 272

Tis Hazari Courts, New Delhi

DP/10163/N/2026

(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Notice No. 2026-July-05
E-TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N. C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:
SN: 1 Tender No.: 2026-July-05-01 Approx Cost ₹: 96594781.22
Description of work: Provision of pathways at various stations under jurisdiction of ADEN/HQ/Agra & ADEN/Line/IDH
SN: 2 Tender No.: 2026-July-05-03 Approx Cost ₹: 21003521.52
Description of work: (A) Provision of Toolboxes with Rest rooms for each Gang/Units under SSE/P. Way/AA under ADEN/HQ/Agra (B) Provision of Toolboxes with Rest rooms for each Gang/Units under SSE/PWN/AGC under ADEN/Line/IDH
For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in". Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" upto 15:00 hrs on 12.08.26 1675/26(AK)

North central railways

@CPRONCR

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited
Regd. & Corp. office : 1191, Sharda Terraces, Plot 65, Sector - 11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai - 400614. CIN: L65922MH2008PLC261472.

POSSESSION NOTICE

Whereas The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the M/s. Suryoday Small Finance Bank Ltd., under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued a demand notice to the mentioned Borrower(s) for repayment of the loan amount due on or before the date of receipt of the said notice, The Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on them under section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 6 & 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on the date mentioned hereunder:

Name of Borrower / Co-Borrower/ Guarantor	Date of Demand Notice	17.04.2026
247000005431, 1) MR. RAJESH KUMAR GARG S/O RISHI KESH GARG, 2) MRS. RITU GARG W/O RAJESH KUMAR GARG	Total Outstanding Amount in Rs.	Rs. 38,38,862.47/- as on 07.04.2026
	Date of Possession	22.07.2026 (Symbolic)

Description of Secured Asset(s) /Immovable Property (ies) :- WHEREAS THE FIRST PARTY IS THE ABSOLUTE SOLE OWNER AND IN POSSESSION OF BUILT-UP SECOND FLOOR WITHOUT ROOF TOP RIGHTS, OUT OF PROPERTY PLOT BEARING NO. 1-15 NEW NO.1-15A, AREA MEASURING 100 SQ. YDS., OUT OF KHASRA NO. 431 AND 433, SITUATED IN THE AREA OF VILLAGE-NAWADA, DELHI, STATE DELHI AND COLONY KNOWN AS MOHAN GARDEN, IN BLOCK-A, UTTAM NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110059, FULLY FITTED WITH SEPARATE METERS & CONNECTION OF ELECTRICITY, WATER, COMMON SEWER CONNECTIONS IN WORKING ORDERS, WITH COMMON CAR PARKING SPACE ON GROUND FLOOR, WITH PROPORTIONATE RIGHTS IN THE FREEHOLD LAND UNDERNEATH AND WITH COMMON RIGHTS TO USE INGRESS & EGRESS, COMMON STAIRCASES & PASSAGE, COMMON UTILITY, WITH ALL ITS FITTINGS AND FIXTURES INSTALLED THEREIN, INCLUDING WOODEN, SANITARY AND ELECTRICAL ETC. WITH ALL ITS RIGHTS, INTEREST, DEPOSITS, EASEMENTS, TITLE, OPTIONS, PRIVILEGES, APPURTENANCE ATTACHED THERETO ETC. BY VIRTUE OF SALE DEED DULY REGISTERED AS DOCUMENT NO.15014, IN BOOK NO.1-VOL. NO.7639, ON PAGES NO.78 TO 86, ON 07.06.2022, IN THE OFFICE OF THE SUB-REGISTRAR-IIB, JANAK PURI, NEW DELHI 110058, EXECUTED BY SMT. RANJANA SALHOTRA W/O SHRI DAS GUJJARMAL, AND WHICH IS BOUNDED AS UNDER: EAST: 1-15 WEST 1-14 NORTH: GALI 10 FT. SOUTH: ROAD 20 FT. (HEREINAFTER CALLED THE PROPERTY).

Name of Borrower / Co-Borrower/ Guarantor	Date of Demand Notice	15.04.2026
257000003370, 1) MR. NARESH SAINI S/O DESH RAJ SAINI, 2) MRS. MEGHA SAINI W/O NARESH SAINI	Total Outstanding Amount in Rs.	Rs. 13,11,263.31/- as on 08.04.2026
	Date of Possession	22.07.2026 (Symbolic)

Description of Secured Asset(s) /Immovable Property (ies) :- ALL THAT PIECE AND PARCEL OF FIRST FLOOR (REAR LEFT SIDE PORTION) WITHOUT ROOF/TERRACE RIGHTS OF BUILT-UP 2ND FLOOR BEARING NO.39, LAND MEASURING 100 SQ. YDS., IN BLOCK-A, AREA MEASURING 100 SQ. YDS., OUT OF KHASRA NO.123, SITUATED IN THE VERGE ESTATE OF VILLAGE BINDAPUR, DELHI STATE DELHI, AREA ABADI KNOWN AS COLONY O-BLOCK EXTN., VANI VIHAR, UTTAM NAGAR, NEW DELHI 110059 BOUNDED AS FOLLOW: EAST :- PROPERTY NO.38 WEST:- PART OF BUILDING NORTH :- FRONT PORTION SOUTH:- GALI 10 FT. WIDE.

The Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the M/s Suryoday Small Finance Bank Ltd, for an above mentioned demanded amount and further interest thereon.

Place : Delhi, Date : 24.07.2026 Authorised Officer, Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited

ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd, 4/10, Mytree Tower, Bormmanhalli Hosur Main Road Bangalore- 560068

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice. Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Nirosha & Babu/ Plot No. 3 No. 4 Plot No. 3 No. 5 Sabari Nagar No. 3/73 Aringar Anna Street, Pakkam Thiruvallur-602024, 223 1/4 Chennai-602022/ LBCHE00005776014	Schedule of Property All That Piece And Parcel of Land With Building Bearing Measuring An Extent of 2773 Sq.ft., And Building 1134 Sq.ft Comprised In Survey No.223, As Per Natham Manai Vari Patta No.226 New Survey No.876/4, Situated At Pakkam Village, Thiruvallur Taluk, Thiruvallur District, Item No.1 Bounded on The North By: Aringar Anna Veethi, South By: Munuswamy Nanjai Land, East By: P.g Loganatha Chettiyar Land, West By: Sekar Paariyal Neela Land Measuring on Measuring on North By: 23 ½ Feet South By: 23½ Feet East By: 118 Feet West By: 118 Feet Item No.2, All That Piece And Parcel of Land With Building Bearing Measuring An Extent of 1387 Sq.ft., Comprised In Survey No. 223, Situated At Pakkam Village, Thiruvallur Taluk, Thiruvallur District, Bounded on The North By: Anna Street, South By: Kuppammanna Nanjai Land, East By: Kaayambu Nadhar House Land, West By: N. Latha Land, Measuring on North By: 11 ¾ Feet South By: 114 Feet East By: 118 Feet West By: 118 Feet In All Total (2773+1387)=4160 Sq.ft And Building 1134 Sq.ft, Situated Within The Sub-registration District of Thiruvallur And Registration District of Thiruvallur. Date of Symbolic Possession 21th July 2026	February 03, 2026 Rs. 33,97,867.48/-	Delhi, Chennai & Madar-pakkam

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: July 24, 2026

Place: Delhi/NCR

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice. Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Pratibha Gupta/ Sumit Gupta/ LBDEL00005161208	Hig Plot No. C-47, Sector-1, Pocket C, Shatabdi Nagar, Meerut- 250002, Owned By Pratibha Gupta/ July 21, 2026	April 29, 2026 Rs. 92,21,414/-	Delhi/ Ncr/ Meerut
2.	Pratibha Gupta / Sumit Gupta / LBDEL00005388216	Hig Plot No. C-48, Sector-1, Pocket C, Block C, Shatabdi Nagar, Meerut 250002, Owned By Pratibha Gupta/ July 21, 2026	April 29, 2026 Rs. 29,79,004.88/-	Delhi/ Ncr/ Meerut

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: July 24, 2026

Place: Delhi/Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

● NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
CANCELLATION

Cancellation to Tender No. 2026-July -03-01 dated 13.07.2026

7

● NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

Tender No. 01 of Tender Notice No. 2026-July-03 dated 13.07.2026 which was scheduled to be opened on 03.08.2026 may please be treated as cancelled.
The details may please be seen on the Indian Railways website "<http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in>" and "<http://www.tenders.gov.in>". 1592/26 (A)
North central railways **@CPRONCR**

millenniumpost

CLASSIFIEDS

CHANGE OF NAME

"I, Neetu Singh, W/o Raj kumar, Resident of C-271, Govindpuram, Ghaziabad, have changed my name from Nitoo Panwar / Neetu Panwar to Neetu Singh. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Neetu Singh for all future purposes."

● NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No. PRYJ-Sig-022-2026-27 **Dated:** 21.07.2026

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Coordination/North Central Railway / Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to **12.00 hrs.** on the opening date of E-tender mentioned therein. **The details of the Tender are as under:-**

Tender No.: 022

Approx. Cost of Work : ₹ 2,94,61,884.59

Name of Work: Comprehensive AMC of SMPS based IPS systems (STATCON make) installed at stations and Relay Huts/Gates in Sr. DSTE/Sig/PRYJ's Section of PRYJ Division for a period of Two years.

Bid Security : ₹ 589200.00	Cost of Tender form: ₹ 0.00
Completion Period : 24 Months	Date of Opening of Tender : 18.08.2026

Availability of tender form: Tender forms are available on www.ireps.gov.in. Bid Security to be deposited: The prescribed amount of Bid Security as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Bid Security in any other form than specified in GCC shall be acceptable. If the Bid Security deposited by the bidder is in shape of Bank Guarantee, it should be supported by proper stamp duty, rate prescribed as per section 13 & 24 of the UP Stamp Act, 2008 and amended from time to time at the time of submission of Bank Guarantee. Tenders without Bid Security shall be summarily rejected. **Time, Date & Place of opening of Tender:** Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj at or after 12.30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be a holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day. **Validity of offer:** 60 days from the date of opening. **Right of Railway to deal with Tender:** Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. 1673/26 (A)

North central railways

@CPRONCR

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

ICICI Bank

Regd. Office: ICICI Bank Limited, Landmark, Race Course Circle, Vadodra- 390007
Corporate Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai- 400051
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Shal Tower Plot No-23, New Rohtak Road Karol Bagh New Delhi-110005
Notice for Disclosure of Legal Heirs of Deceased Borrower PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice Is Hereby Given That Home Loan LBGHZ00002368656 (Credit Facility) Was Granted To Manmohan Verma of Borrower, Co-Borrower, Guarantor/Mortgagor (Excluding Deceased Borrower) (Borrowers) Along With The Deceased Manmohan Verma By ICICI Bank Ltd, (The Bank).

We Would Like To Inform You That The Demise of Manmohan Verma Has Come To Our Knowledge During Field Visits Conducted By The Bank Officials And By Telephonic Communications on The Registered Contact Numbers. In This Regard, Letter Dated 21. July 20



NEET PROTESTERS

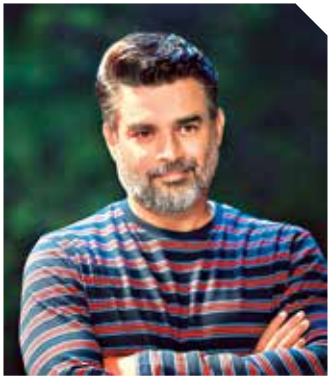
SALMAN, ALIA STAND WITH PROTESTERS

FTTI Chairman R Madhavan finally speaks up on students' protest after criticism

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The student protest over the alleged NEET-UG paper leak, which began at New Delhi's Jantar Mantar under the banner of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), has gathered major momentum over the past seven weeks. What started in the national capital has now spread to several parts of the country and even overseas. As the movement continues to grow, an increasing number of prominent personalities, including several Bollywood A-listers, have come out in support of the students.

While veterans like Naseeruddin Shah and Shabana Azmi were among the first from the film fraternity to express solidarity with the protesters, many others have since joined the movement. Celebrities including Anurag Kashyap, Diljit Dosanjh, Imran Khan, Sonu Sood, Vir Das, Dia Mirza, Soha Ali Khan, Aditi Rao Hydari, Rohit Saraf, Aayush Sharma, Riteish and Genelia Deshmukh, Bhumi Pednekar, Huma Qureshi, Nandita Das,



Konkona Sen Sharma, Atul Kulkarni, Sonakshi Sinha, Vishal Dadlani, Pooja Bhatt, Swara Bhasker, Vijay Varma, Richa Chadha, Soni Razdan, Zeenat Aman and Rajkumar Rao have taken to social media to support the students and urged the government to initiate a dialogue with the protesters.

Although Aamir Khan and Shah Rukh Khan are yet to voice their support for the students, actors Salman Khan and Alia Bhatt have now publicly backed the movement. However, members of the Bachchan and Kapoor families are yet to respond.

On Thursday night, Salman shared a childhood photograph



along with a lengthy note on social media. "It was such a peaceful movement. I feel so sad that it had to take a violent turn. My heart goes out to the students and their families who were hurt. Paper leak is a very serious issue and I am glad to see that the kids of our country have come together for a better educational system, with

the support of their parents," he wrote.

Salman also urged that the movement should remain student-led and not become a political issue. "This issue is between the students and the educational system. It should not be hijacked politically. The credit should only go to the students of our country, and I am sure the government will support them and make the educational system stronger."

Meanwhile, although her husband, actor Ranbir Kapoor, is yet to react to the student protest, Alia Bhatt said the developments of the past few days had broken her heart. "Behind every student standing their ground is a dream, a family's hope, a journey of countless sacrifices. They represent not just themselves but everyone who has supported them, while creating a better path for those who

will come after them," the 'Alpha' actress said.

Meanwhile, R Madhavan, who played Farhan in '3 Idiots', has finally acknowledged the anger among students and parents. His statement came hours after a photograph from outside the Film and Television Institute of India (FTII) went viral on social media. The image showed a poster carrying the words 'Gayab' and 'NEET for Sale', "As someone who has always believed in the limitless potential of India's youth, I share the concern and disappointment felt by so many students and parents today," the 'Dhurandhar' actor wrote.

Bollywood has often been criticised for remaining silent on major social and political issues. This time, however, the voices of support are growing louder with each passing day. While A-listers such as Shah Rukh Khan, Aamir Khan, Amitabh Bachchan, Ranbir Kapoor, Ranveer Singh and Akshay Kumar are yet to comment on the issue, more celebrities continue to join the movement. Actors including Imran Khan, Huma Qureshi, Saqib Saleem, Jim Sarbh, Naseeruddin Shah and Shabana Azmi have also been physically present at the protest marches, lending their support to the students.

Actors including Imran Khan, Huma Qureshi, Saqib Saleem, Jim Sarbh and Shabana Azmi have been physically present at the protest marches



Viral Feed

Sharvari

poses playfully with her signature cheeky smile in a chic summer dress



'Adam Driver repeatedly passed on MCU roles'

Kevin Feige said Driver has repeatedly turned down opportunities to join the MCU

Marvel Studios' president Kevin Feige said actor Adam Driver has repeatedly turned down opportunities to join the 'Marvel Cinematic Universe', but the studio remains interested in working with the Oscar-nominated star.

Speaking on the 'Happy Sad Confused' podcast recently, Feige said the studio has held several conversations with Driver over the years, but the actor has declined each time. "It's no secret we'd like to (work with Adam). But it's a tradition to 'Zoom' with him and then he passes. That's a long-lived tradition. He couldn't be more cordial. He is usually upfront about how he is feeling," Feige said.

Feige didn't disclose which 'Marvel' roles Driver had been offered. Addressing speculation that the actor is being considered to play Magneto in Marvel Studios' upcoming 'X-Men' reboot, he said no casting decisions have been made for the project.

Driver is best known for playing Kylo Ren, also known as Ben Solo,



Feige didn't disclose which 'Marvel' roles Driver had been offered

in the latest 'Star Wars' trilogy. Last year, the actor said he had explored returning to the 'Star Wars' franchise through a proposed film centred on Ben Solo with filmmaker Steven Soderbergh, but the project didn't move forward. Driver said 'Lucasfilm' responded positively to the idea, but 'Disney' executives Bob Iger and Alan Bergman ultimately decided against pursuing the film. PTI

WHEN IN KOLKATA

Mani Ratnam to shoot his next with Vijay Sethupathi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

After 16 years, veteran filmmaker Mani Ratnam is back in Kolkata to shoot his upcoming film. The last time he shot in the city was for Raavan in 2010. Earlier, he shot 'Yuva' in 2004.

Actor Vijay Sethupathi has already arrived in Kolkata. Known for his trademark beard, the 'Maharaja' actor is sporting a clean look this time. He is reportedly pairing up with Sai Pallavi in Ratnam's Telugu film.

Sources say several actors from the Bengali film industry will be part of the legendary filmmaker's project. Sources also inform that Bengali actors like Durbar Sharma, Arijita Mukhopadhyay and Ritwika Pal will appear in the film. Meanwhile, a photograph of the 'Dil Se' director with the technicians of Bengal has gone viral.

The 'Roja' director is expected to spend nearly two weeks filming in the city. Sources inform that the filmmaker is planning to shoot at Belgachia Rajbari, Howrah Bridge, Kumartuli, Park Street and the Technicians' Studio complex.

The film is reportedly going on the floor on Friday in Kolkata. Ratnam's last film, 'Thug Life' in 2025, starring Kamal Haasan, failed to impress the audience at the box office.



Ratnam's last film, 'Thug Life', in 2025 starring Kamal Haasan, failed to impress the audience at the box office

'South cinema wants its villains from Hindi cinema'

Bobby Deol stars as the antagonist in Vijay's 'Jana Nayagan'

South Indian cinema runs on heroism. The hero is not just the lead actor; he is the centre of the universe and the film unravels around him. He is worshipped on screen and off it too. And for that celebration to land, the villain has to be big enough to make the hero's victory feel earned. That, according to Bobby Deol, is why Hindi actors keep getting cast as antagonists in Tamil and Telugu films.

"It's a different world out there, in the sense that they have a lot of heroism. They worship the heroes. So, they always want their villains to be from Hindi cinema," Bobby Deol said in an interview with 'Galatta Plus'.

It is a pattern the industry has followed for decades. From Bollywood actors being cast as antagonists in Rajinikanth and Kamal Haasan films in the 1990s to the current wave where Bobby Deol, Sanjay Dutt and Sonu Sood routinely play the villain opposite South Indian leads, the logic is the same. A Hindi actor as the villain gives the hero a pan-Indian opponent to conquer. It makes the audience feel like the hero is not just fighting a local threat but taking on someone from the larger, more visible Hindi film industry. Whether that is fair to the Hindi actors involved is a different question. But it works at the box office and that is why it keeps happening.

Bobby Deol has become the most in-demand version of this formula in the last three years. After his career-reviving turn in Sandeep Reddy Vanga's 'Animal' in 2023, the offers from the South have not stopped. He played the villain in Suriya's 'Kan-



It is a pattern the industry has followed for decades

guva'. After that, he faced off against Balakrishna in 'Daaku Maharaja'. He was Aurangzeb opposite Pawan Kalyan in 'Hari Hara Veera Mallu'. And now, he has arrived as the antagonist in Vijay's 'Jana Nayagan', the most anticipated Tamil release of the year and the sitting Chief Minister's final film.

"It's a strange fact, but most of them got into politics and they worked with me before they won the elections," he said, laughing. AGENCIES

